

Spring 2023

Research
September 2023

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey Background

- Covers all modes – Bus, Rail, Light Rail & Access Link
- Conducted in Spring and Fall
- Methodology has remained consistent to track scores over time
  - Customers rate their satisfaction with service traits on a scale of 0 to 10
  - Customers identify the most important service traits
- Survey is administered online with an extensive campaign to increase participation and boost response rates in target markets



Spring 2023 Survey Background

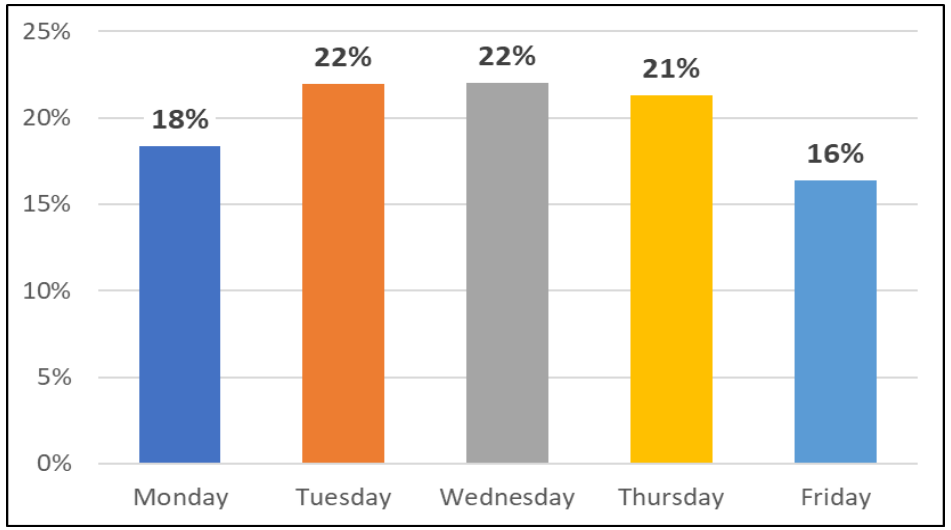
- Conducted from June 5th through July 3rd
- Received about 29,000 surveys
- Survey included standard Customer Satisfaction questions and COVID-related questions
- To encourage more participation -- offered 250 NJT Rewards Points to all customers that completed the survey and were a member or signed up for NJT Rewards

TRANSIT

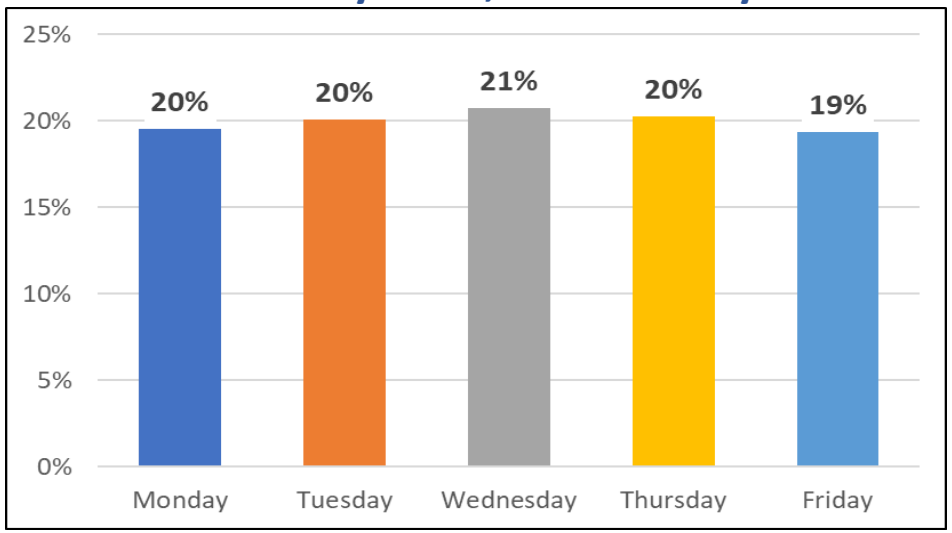
COVID-Related Findings - Distribution of Weekday Work Trips on NJ TRANSIT by Day of the Week

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

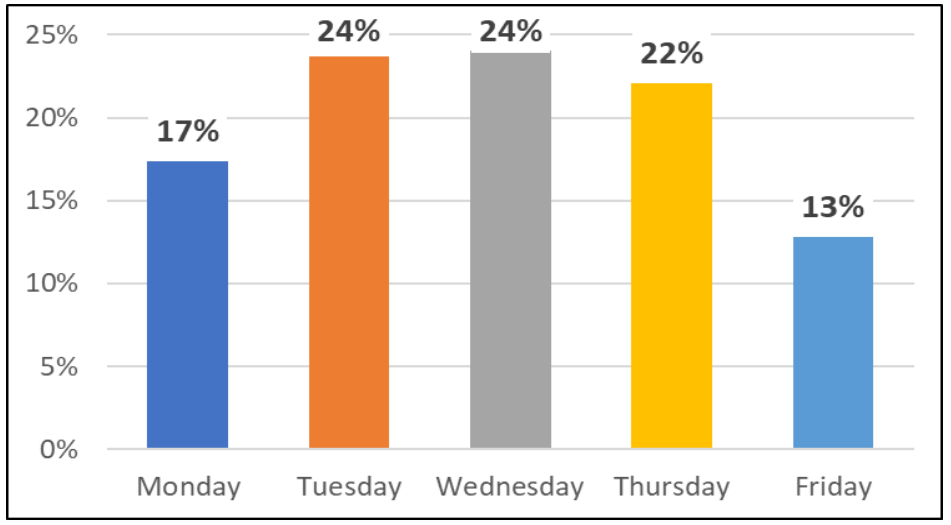
Bus – NY Interstate



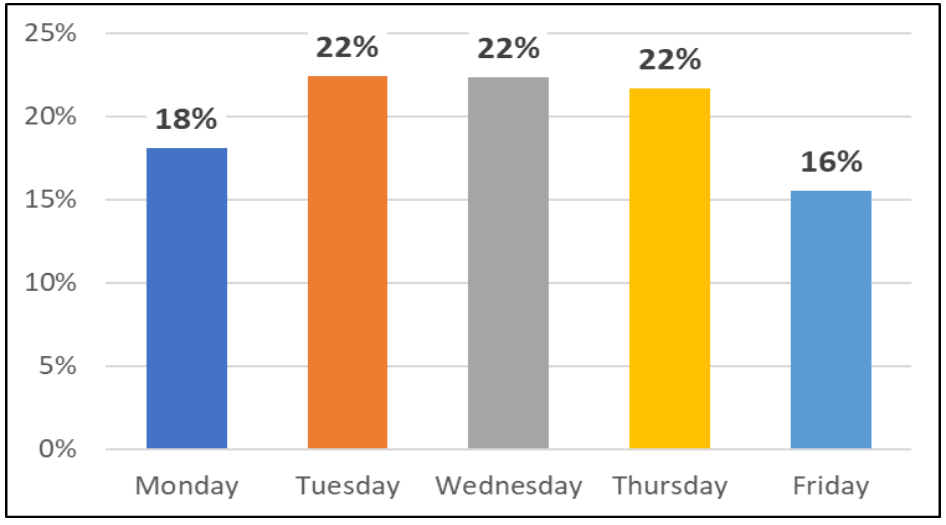
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



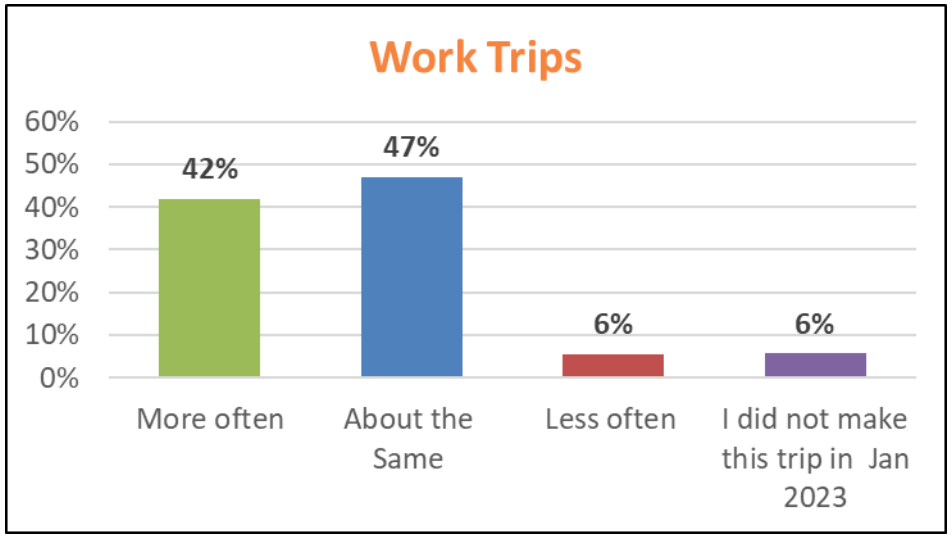
- Most trips to the office or worksite are occurring during the middle of the week
- On Fridays, the fewest customers travel to the office or worksite

NJ TRANSIT

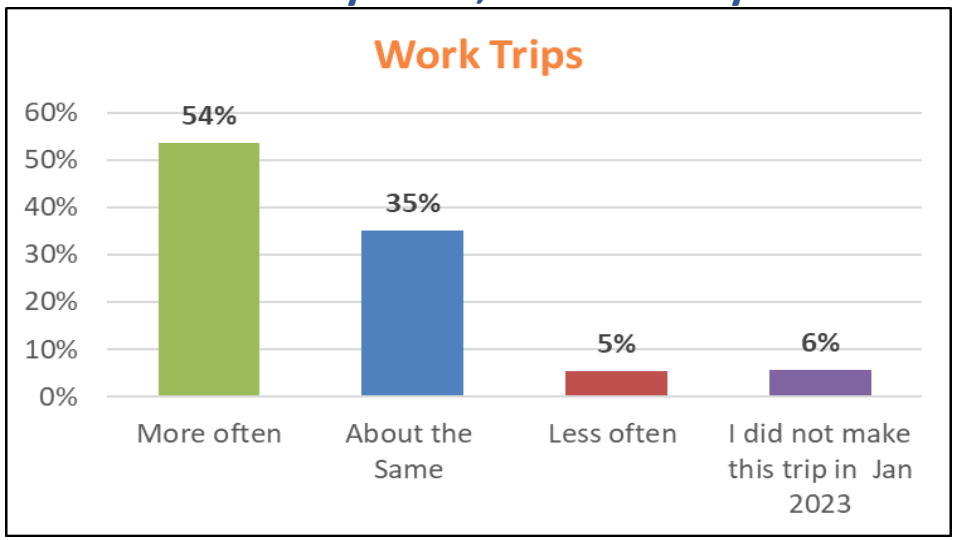
Are you currently traveling (in June 2023) by NJ TRANSIT to WORK More Often, Less Often or about the Same as in January 2023

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

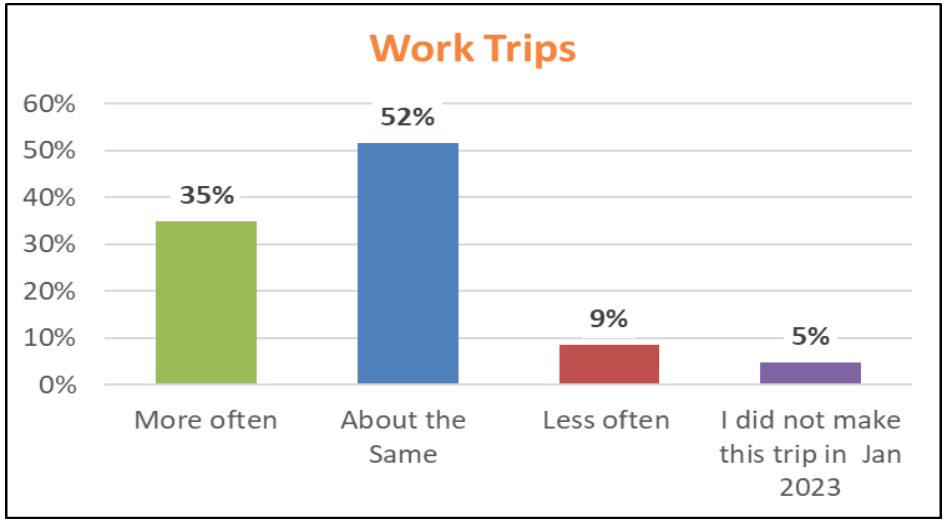
Bus – NY Interstate



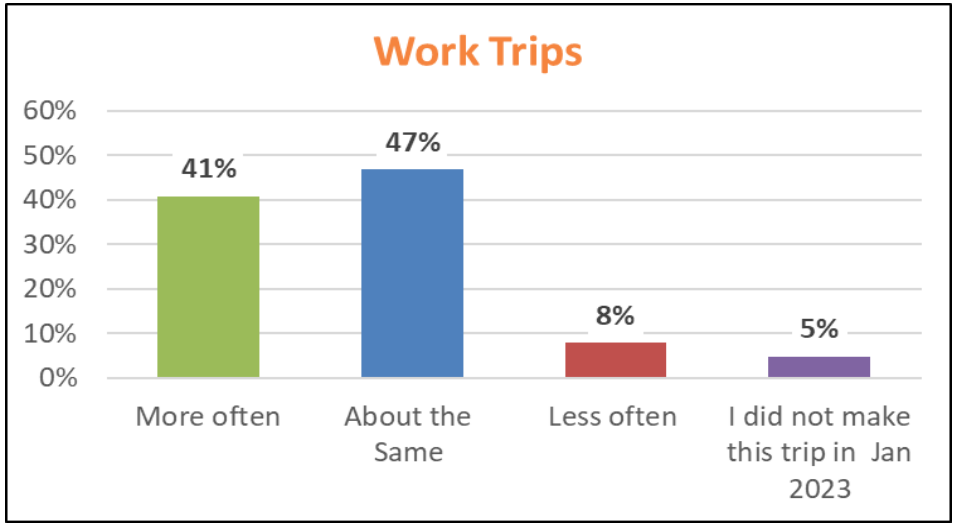
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



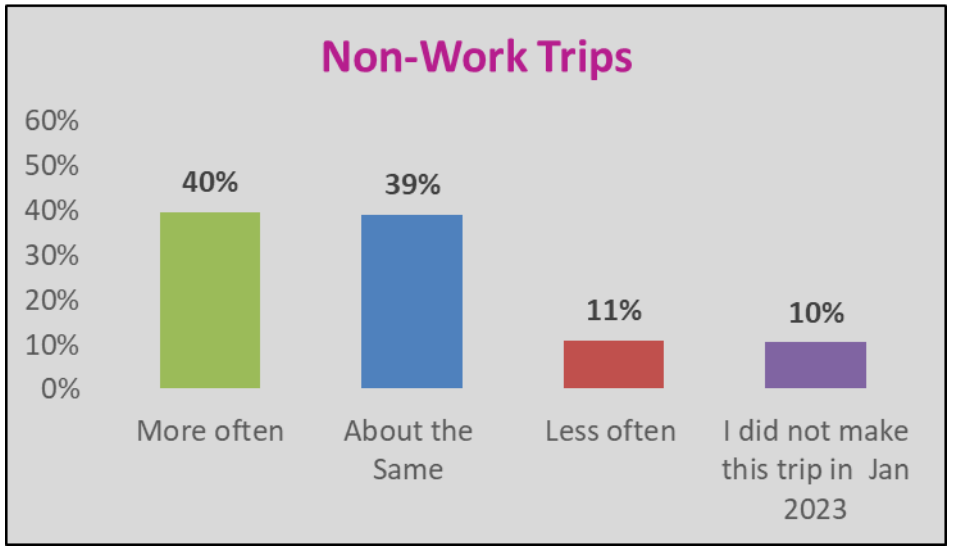
- Customers were making more Work trips on NJ TRANSIT in June 2023 than they were making in January 2023.

TRANSIT

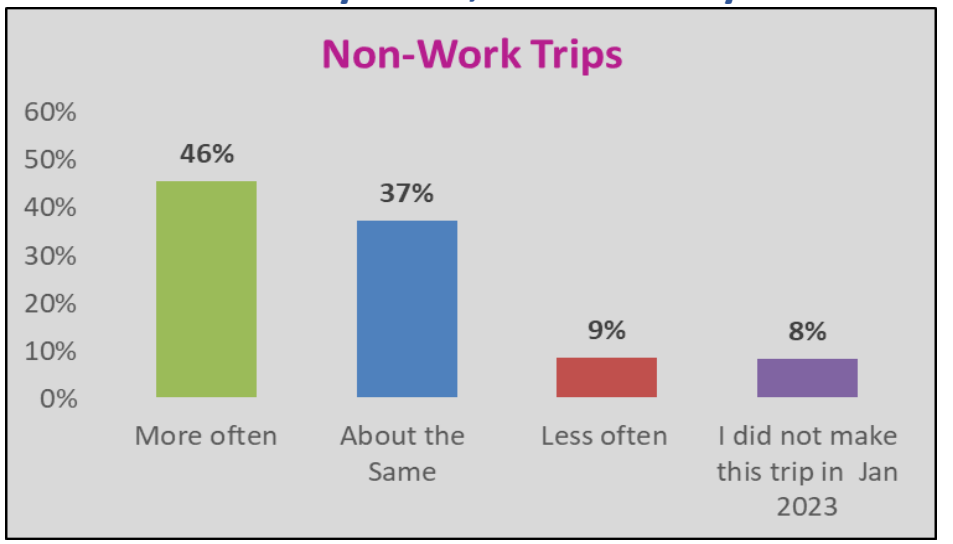
Are you currently traveling (in June 2023) by NJ TRANSIT for a Non-Work trip More Often, Less Often or about the Same as in January 2023

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

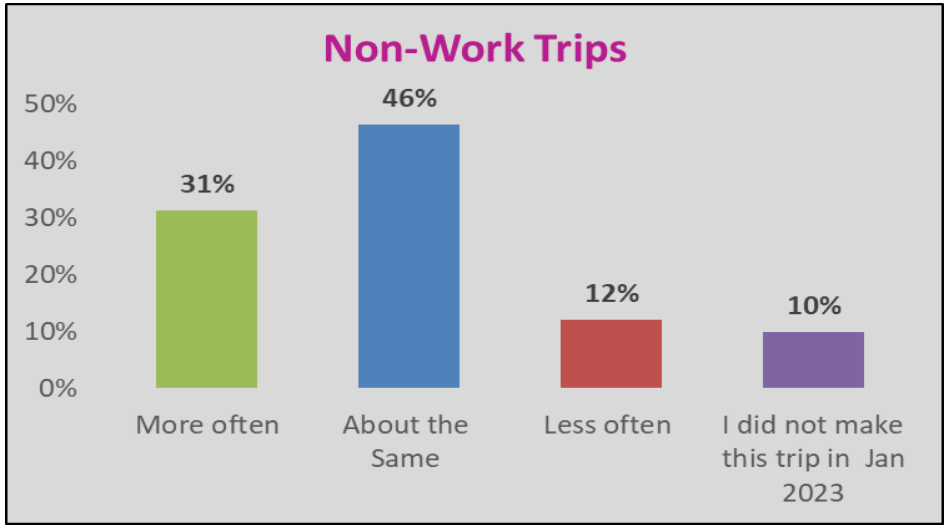
Bus – NY Interstate



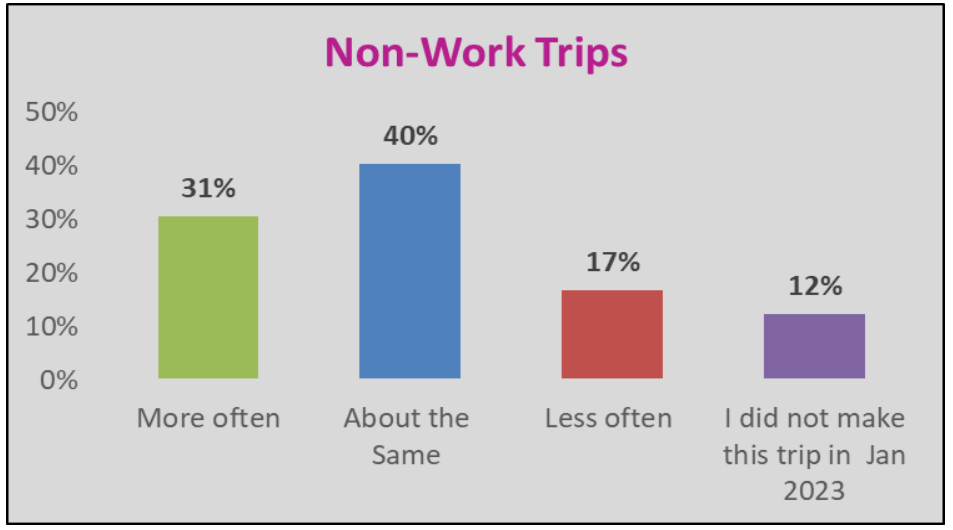
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



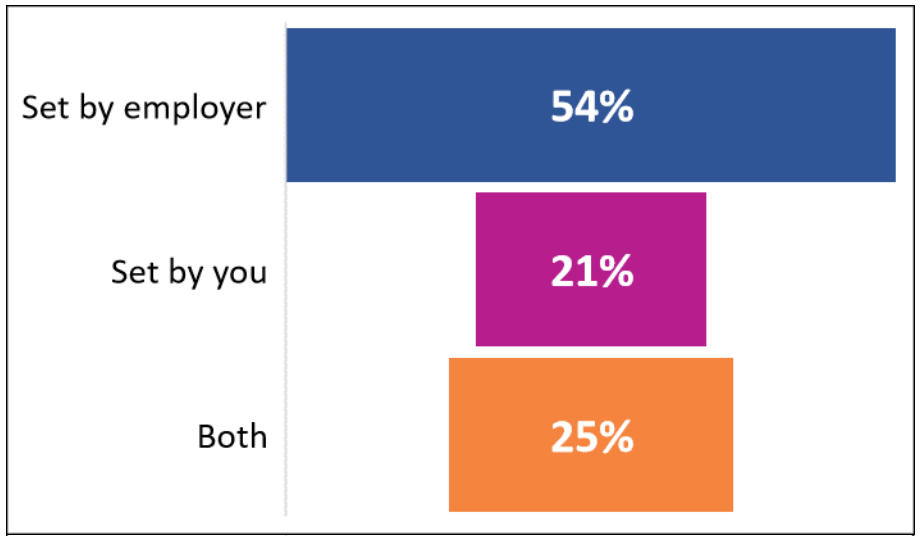
- Customers were making more Non-Work trips on NJ TRANSIT in June 2023 than in January 2023

TRANSIT

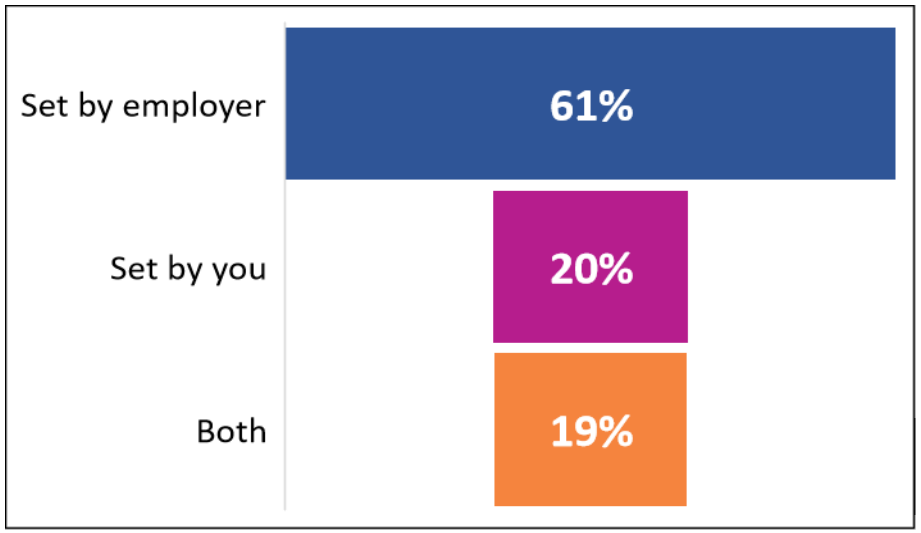
COVID-Related Findings -
Are the typical days that you travel to your office/worksite . . . ?

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

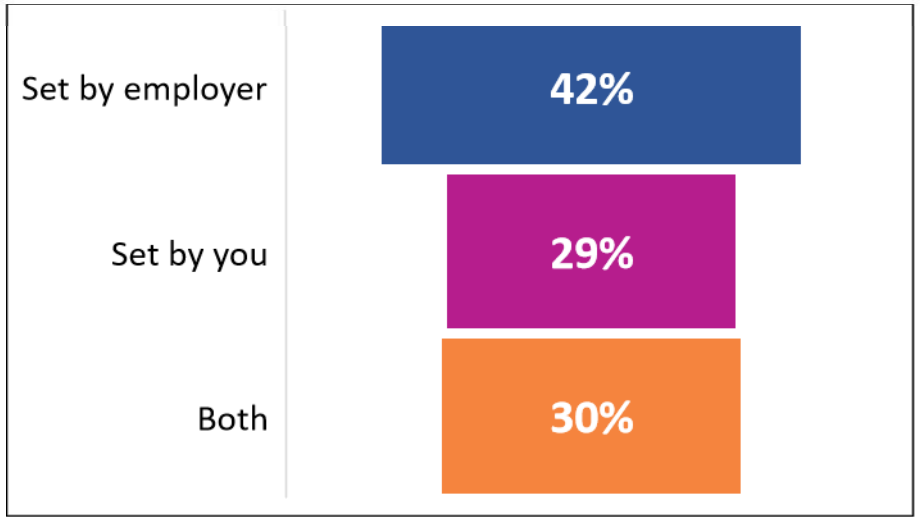
Bus – NY Interstate



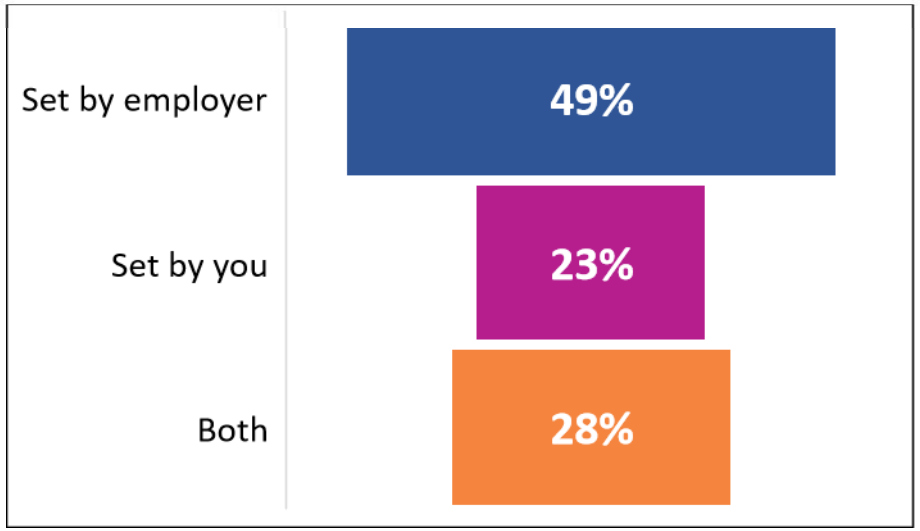
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



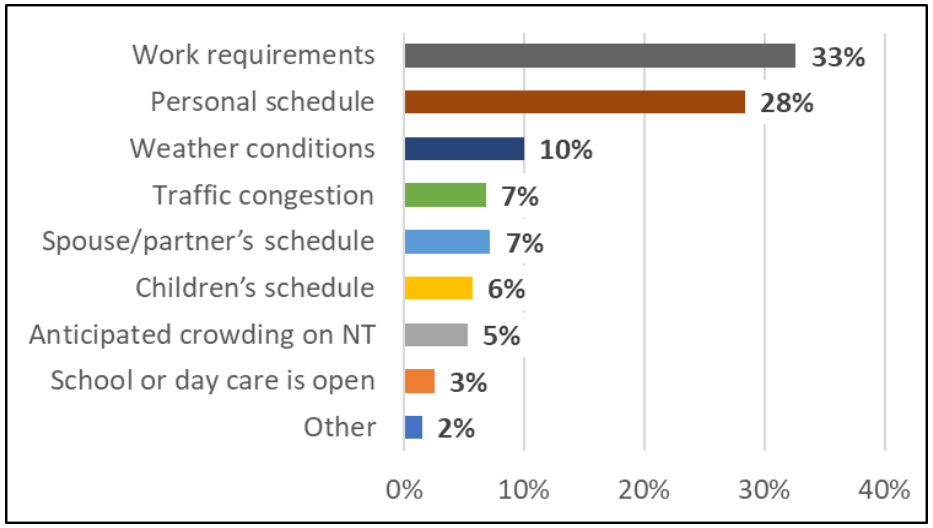
- Of customers that travel to work by NJ TRANSIT, the highest percentage said that their employers set the office days
- Remaining responses are split between being set by the employee and by both employer & employee

TRANSIT

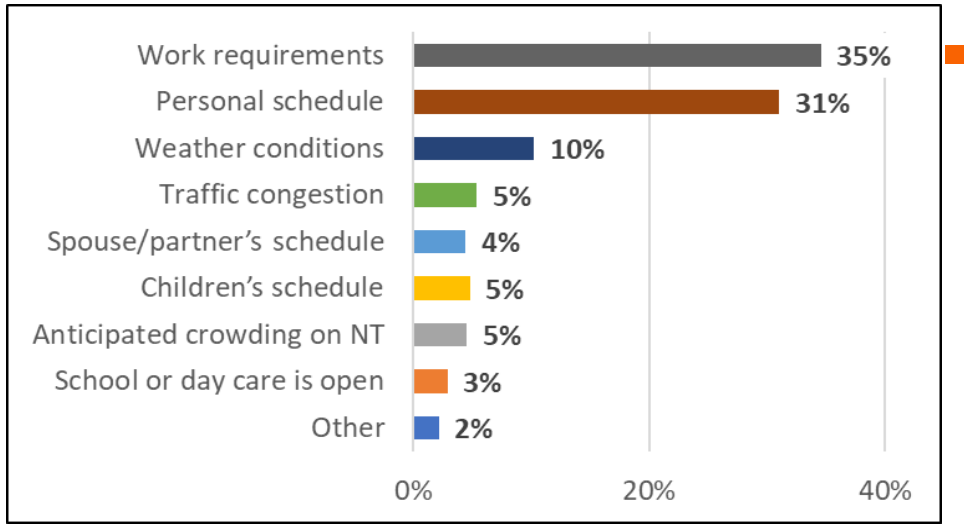
COVID-Related Findings
What factors influenced your decision on which days to go to the office/worksite?

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

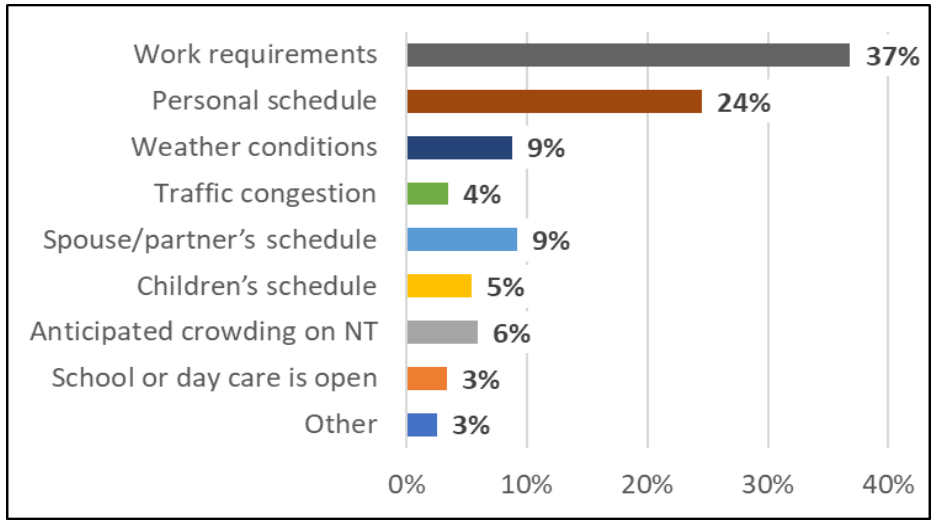
Bus – NY Interstate



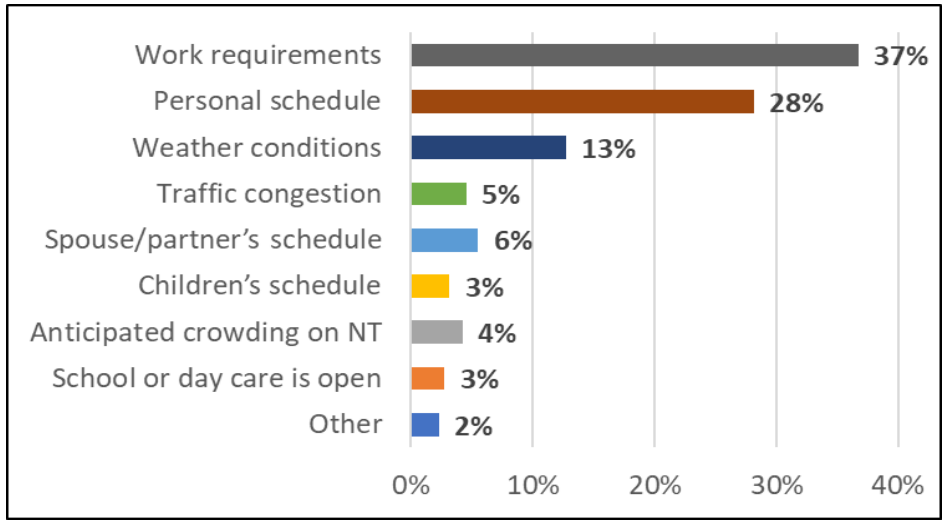
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



- Work requirements, personal schedule and weather are the top factors that influence customer's decisions on which days to travel to the office

Note: select all that apply question

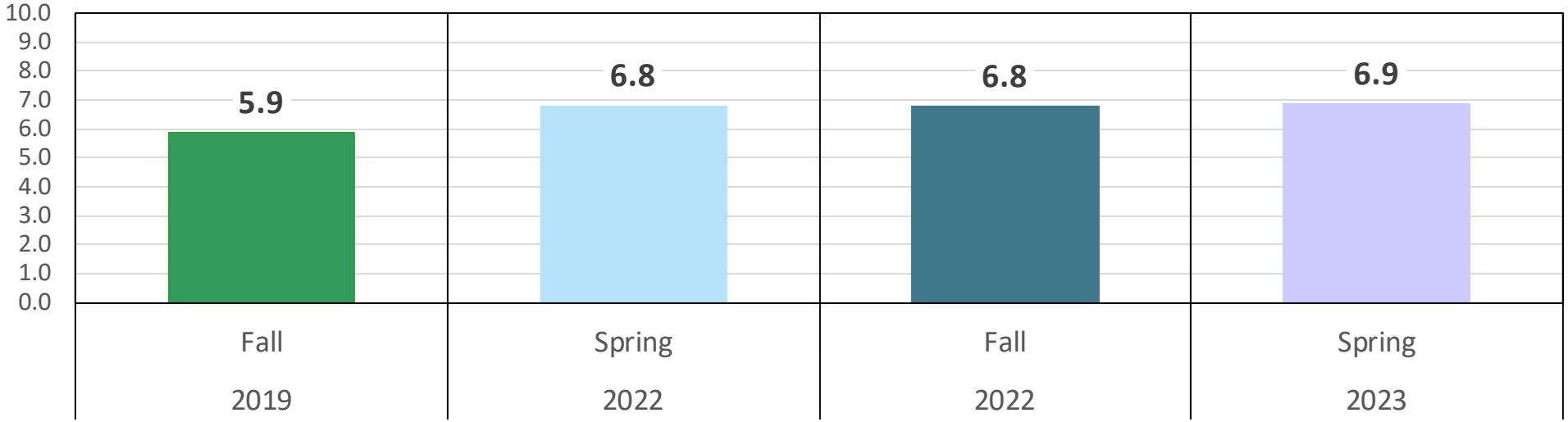
TRANSIT

System-Wide Results

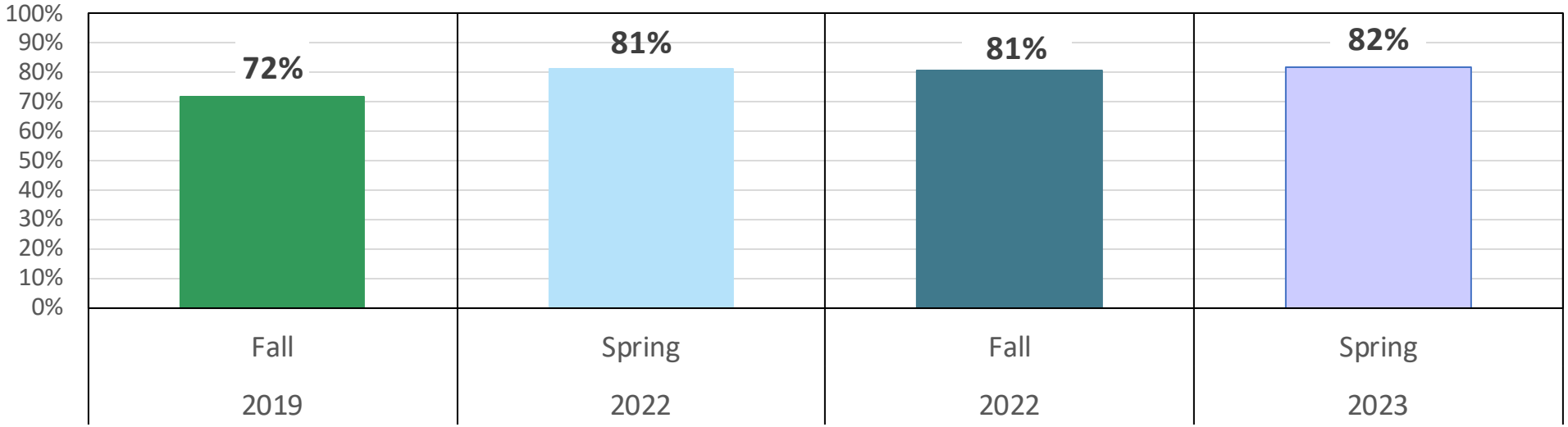
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2023

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT



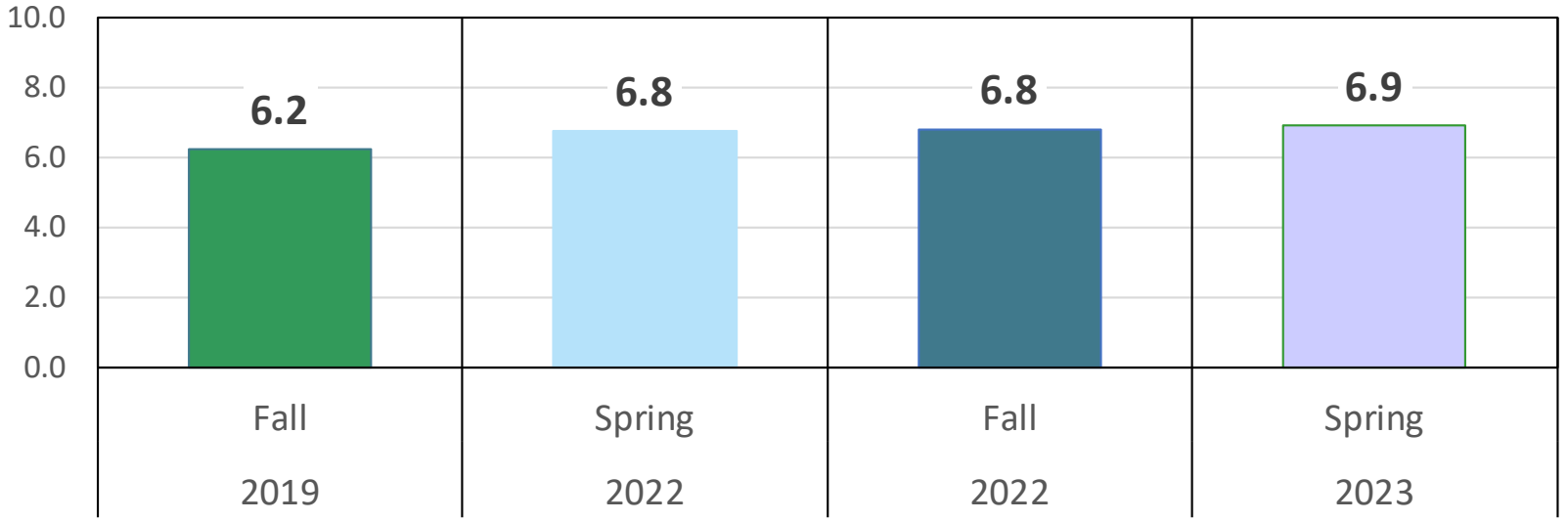
NJ TRANSIT

BUS

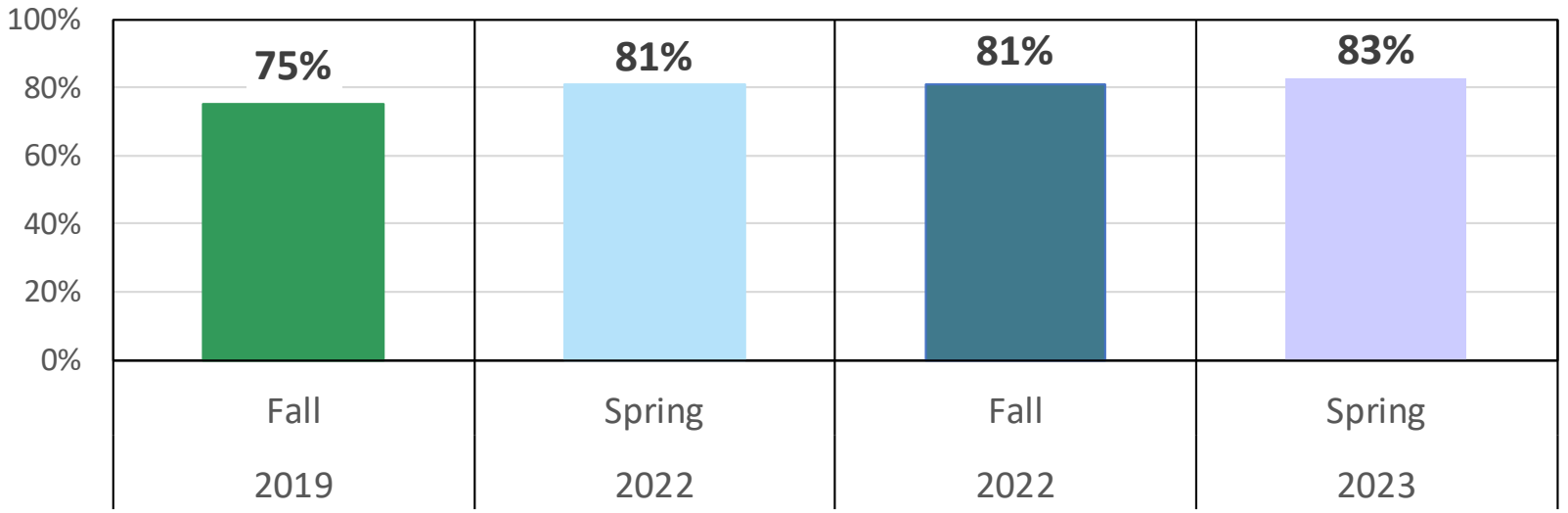
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2023

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE

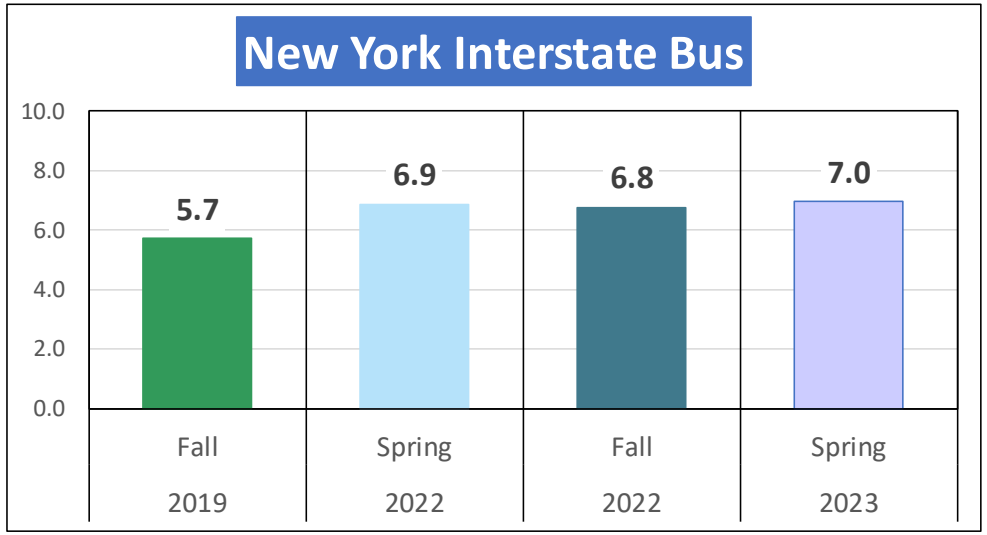


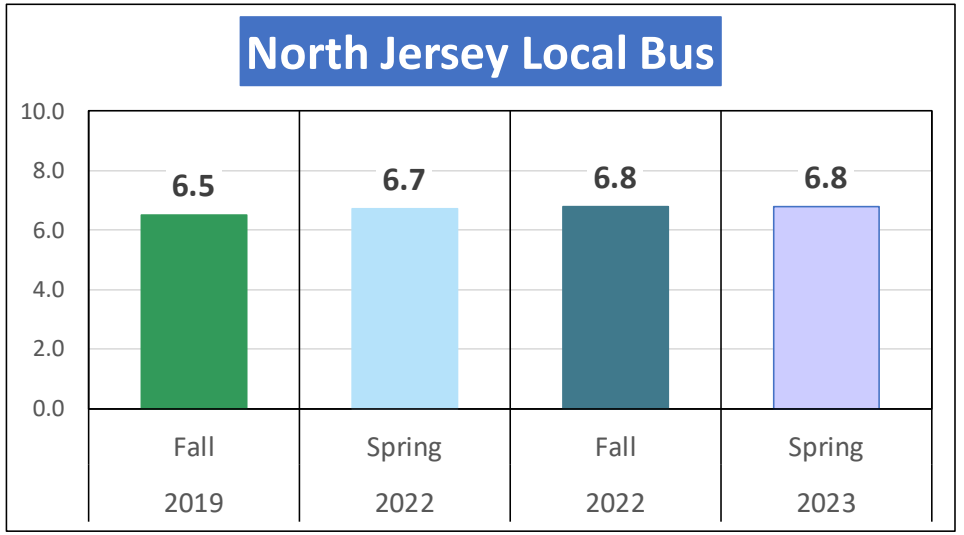
LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT

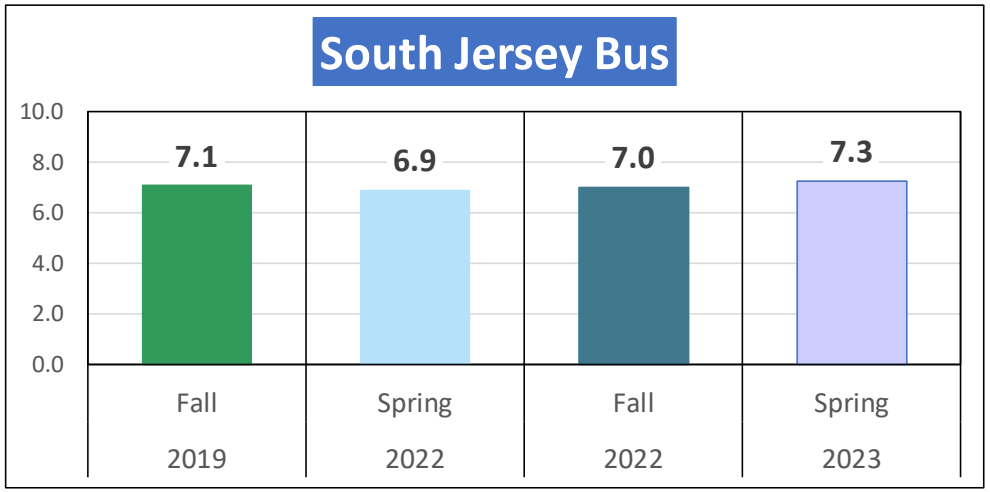


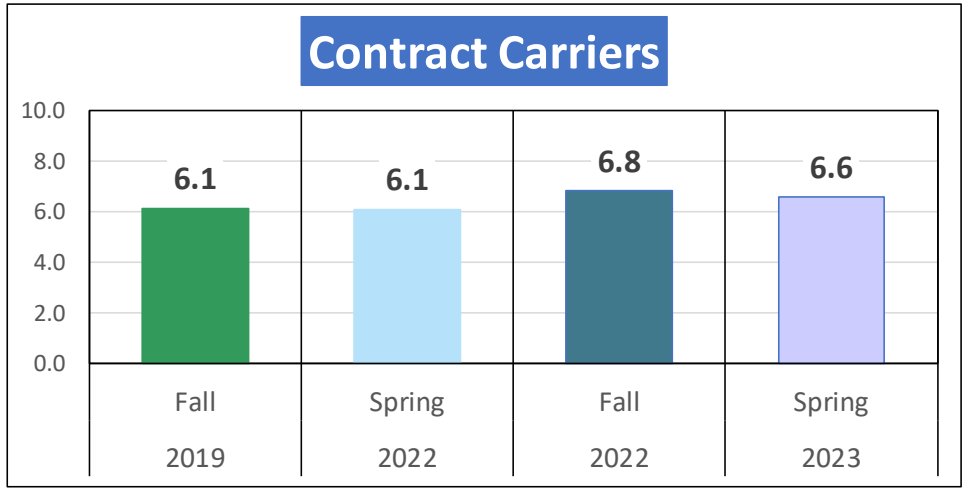
TRANSIT

Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT by Bus Market









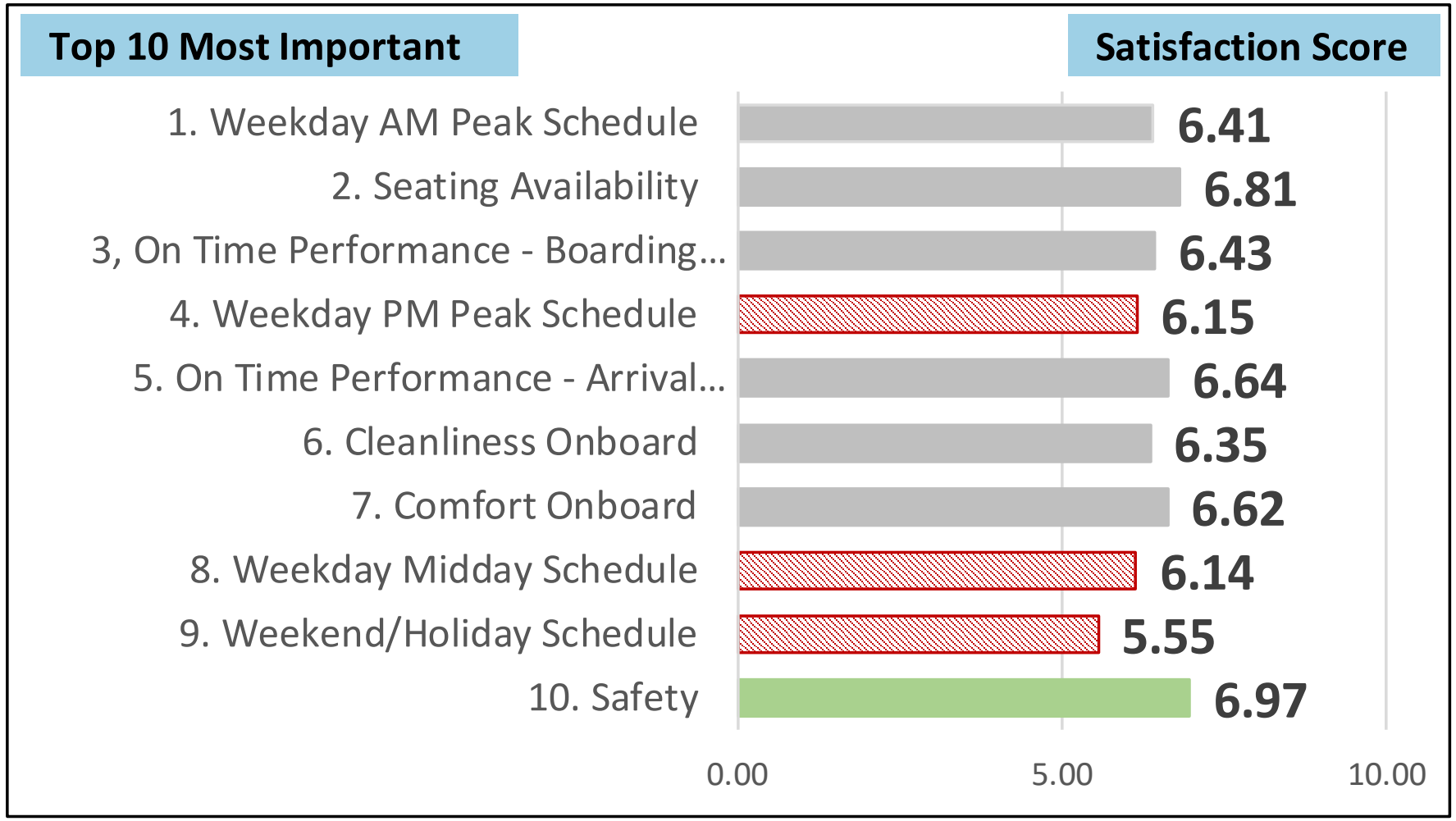
- The overall satisfaction score for the NY Interstate and South Jersey Bus Markets increased, North Jersey Local stayed the same and Contract Carriers declined since the Fall 2022 survey

TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS Customers

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

BUS SYSTEM



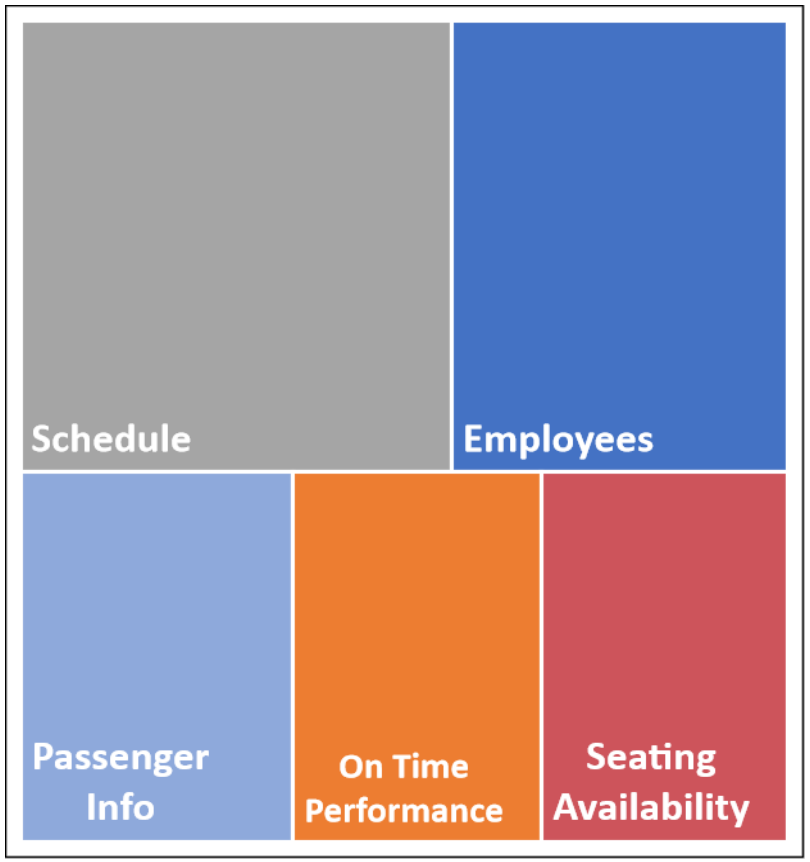
	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of BUS Comments

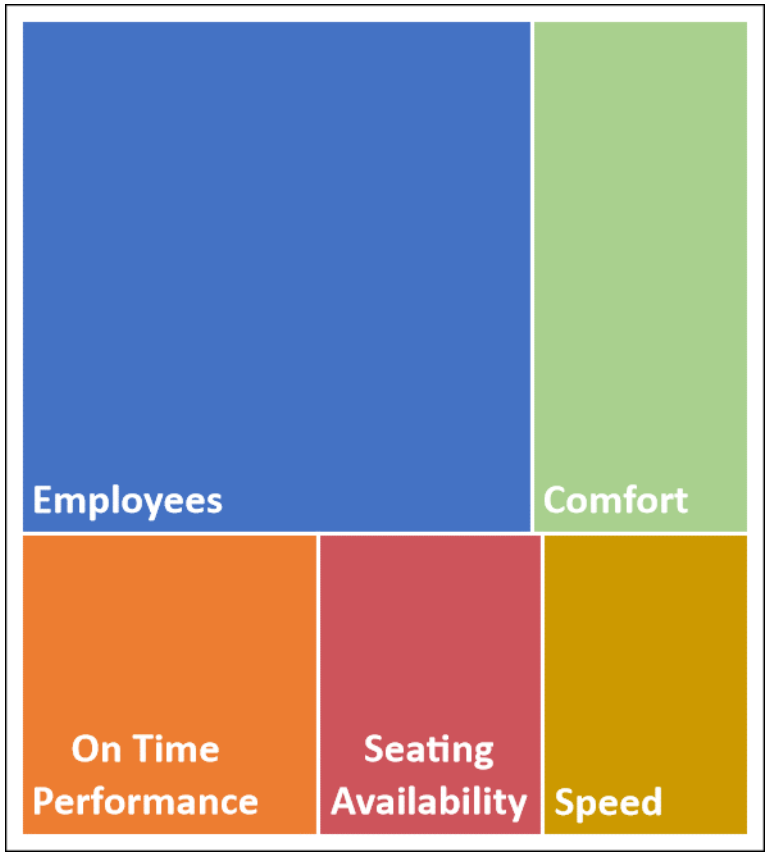
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



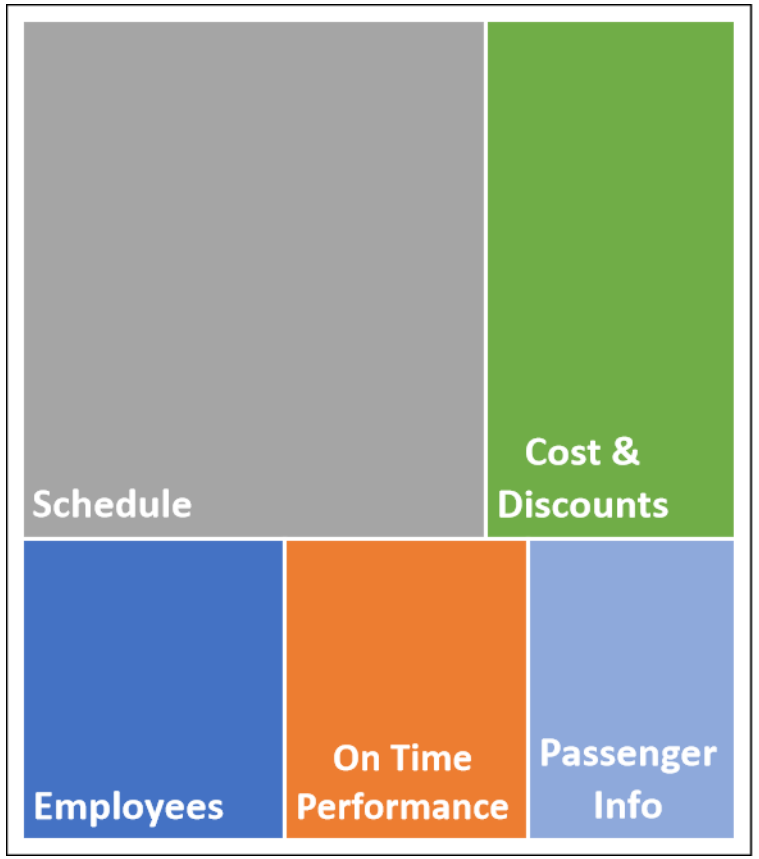
6,710 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



6,405 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



6,069 "Encourage" Comments

11,836 Bus Surveys

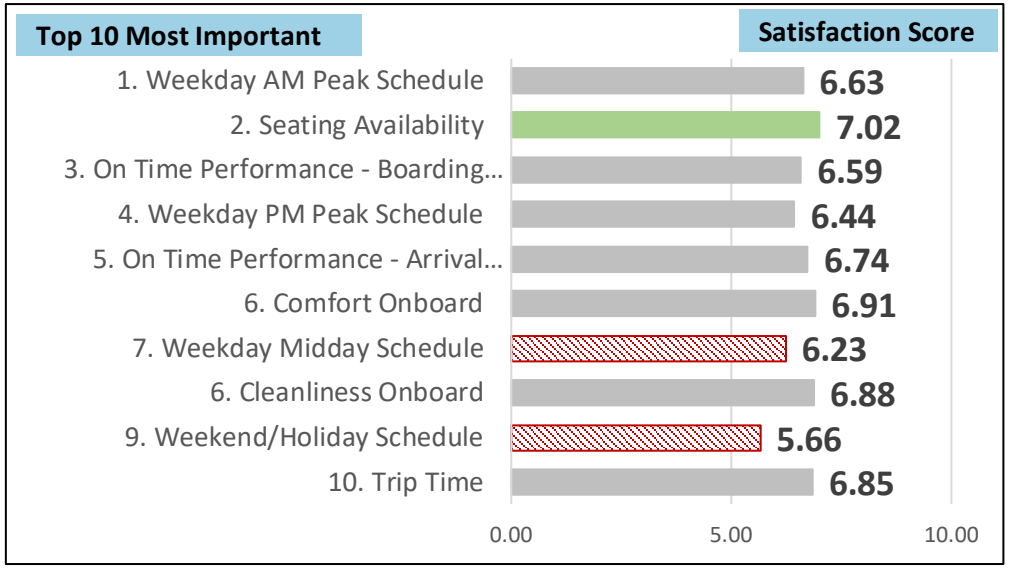
TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS Customers by Bus Market and Score

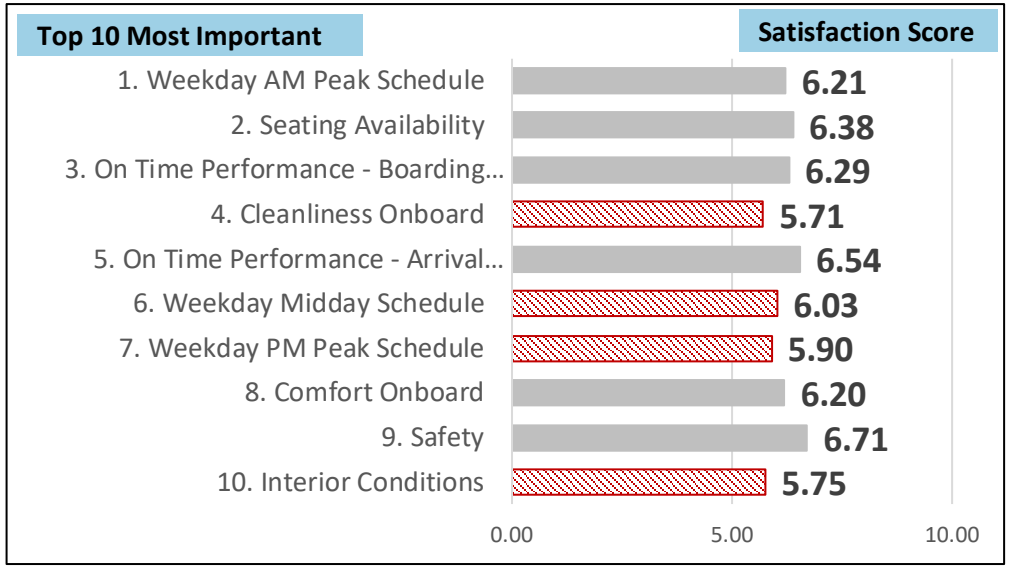
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2023

NY INTERSTATE

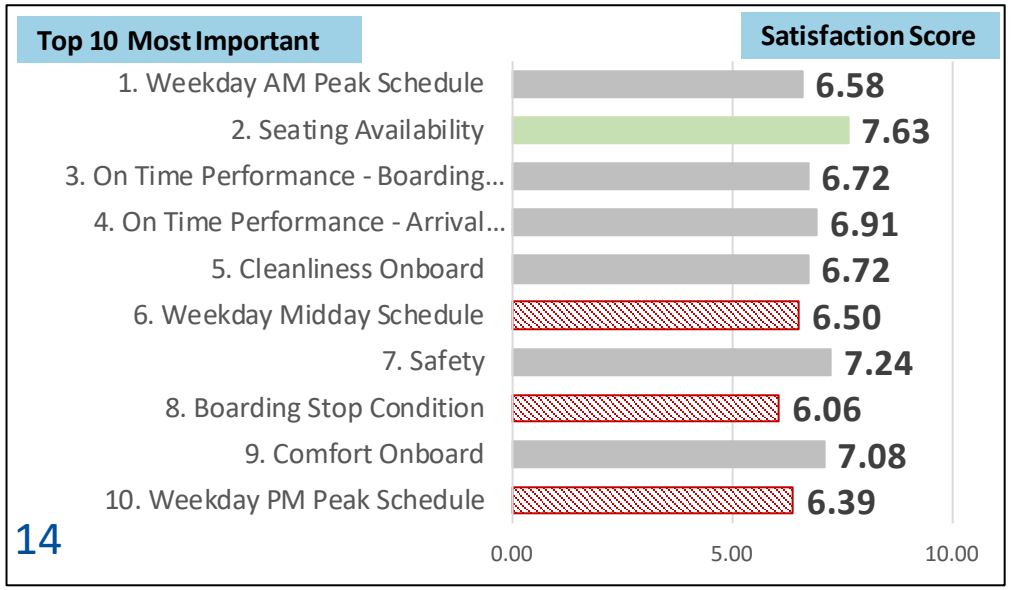


NORTH JERSEY LOCAL

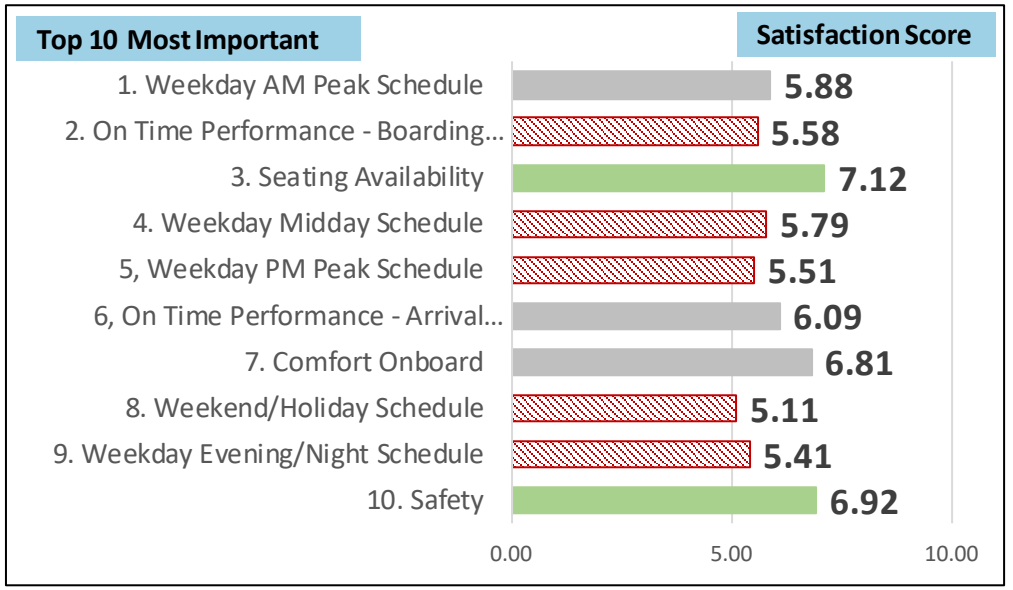


	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

SOUTH JERSEY



CONTRACT CARRIERS



NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Bus Score Context

Operator Hiring/Onboarding Effort

- Ongoing partnership with Human Resources to increase hiring of new bus operators to improve service delivery
- Increased staffing levels = reduction in missed trips and less crowding on buses

Increased Supervision

- Increased monitoring of bus operations across the system, focusing on on-time performance
- Added overnight oversight at the Port Authority Bus Terminal gates

NABI Bus Overhaul

- Began the mid-life rehabilitation of 200 NABI 2012 to 2013 model year buses
- 18 buses completed to date – will impact future survey results as more of the 200 are completed

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Bus Score Context

Service Adjustments

- From Sept. 2022 to June 2023, bus schedules have been enhanced across all service areas:
  - Added 641 weekday, 171 Saturday and 150 Sunday trips to the systemwide schedule
  - Added 156 weekday peak buses with high-capacity articulated buses added to more routes (Nos. 10, 25, 119, 123, 125)
  - Adjusted running time on 106 routes daily to improve reliability
  - Implemented the West Essex Emergency service plan in April 2023 (former DeCamp route service)
  - No. 1 line operating 341 weekday trips (51 more than pre-pandemic); improved frequency to Jersey City and River Terminal
  - Nos. 10 and 119 lines operating 69 additional weekday trips for capacity following takeover
  - On the 119, a new PABT departure gate allows for increased frequency during the PM rush; improved weekend service

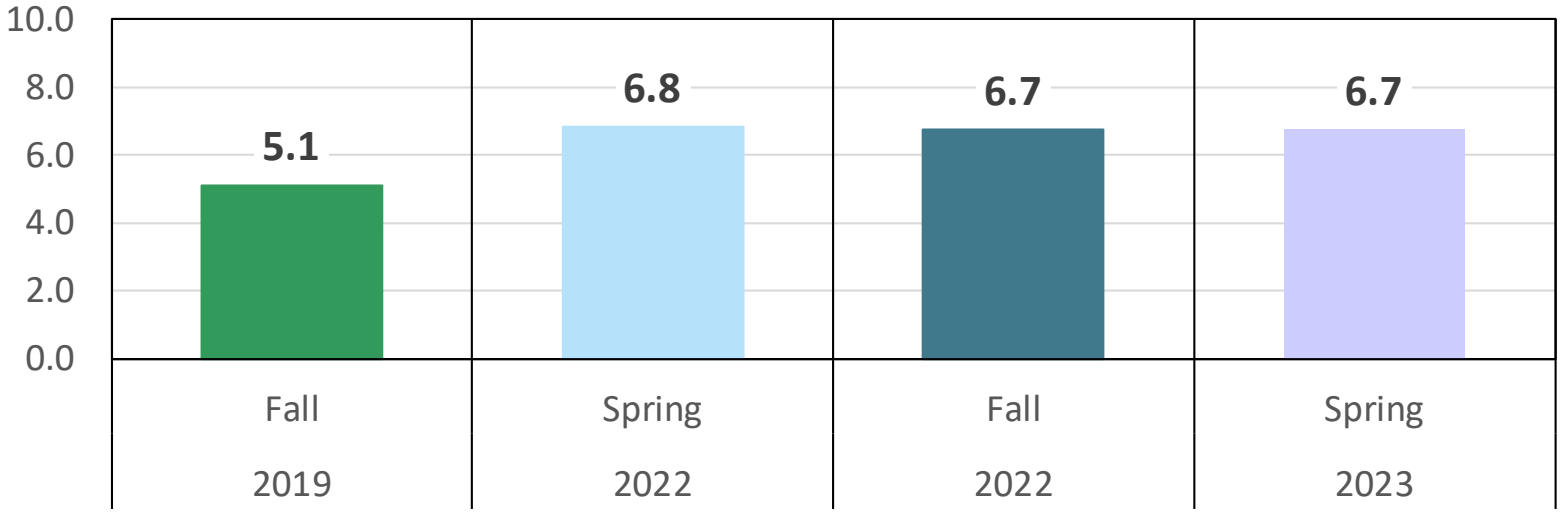
TRANSIT

RAIL

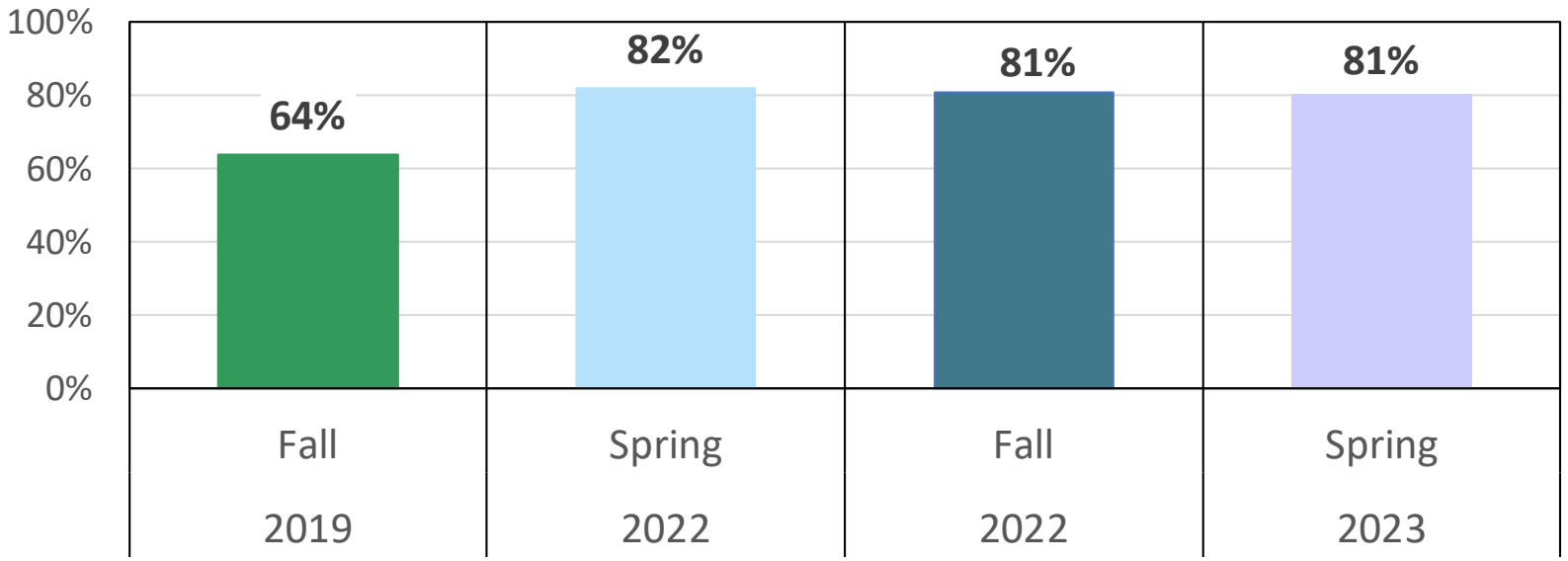
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2023

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE

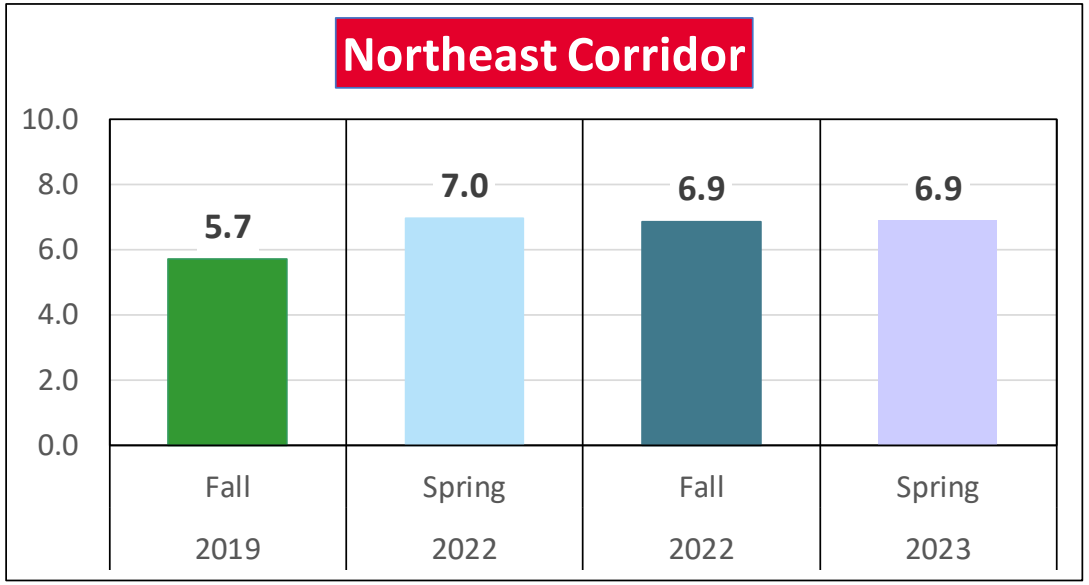


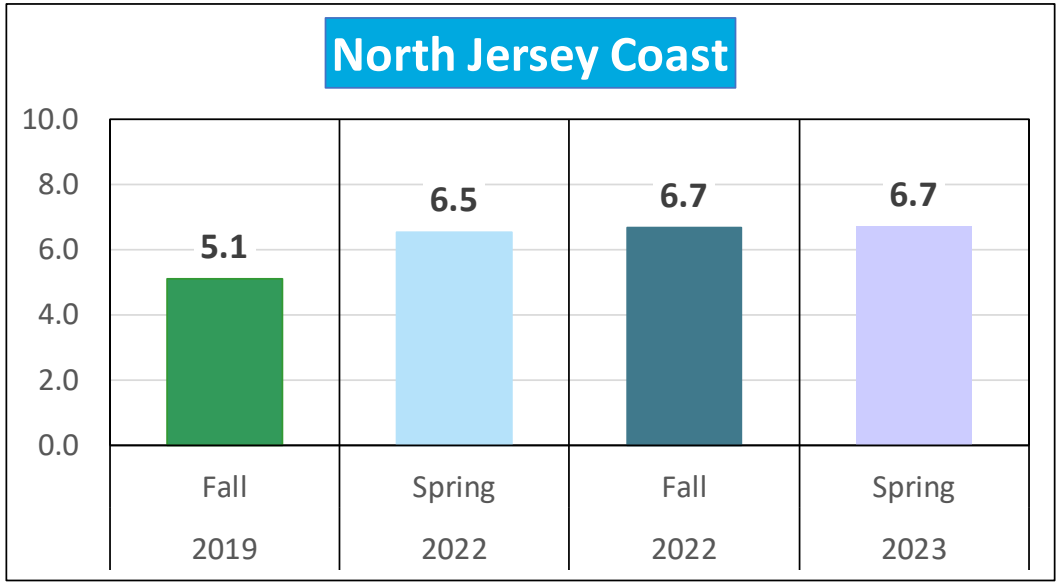
LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT

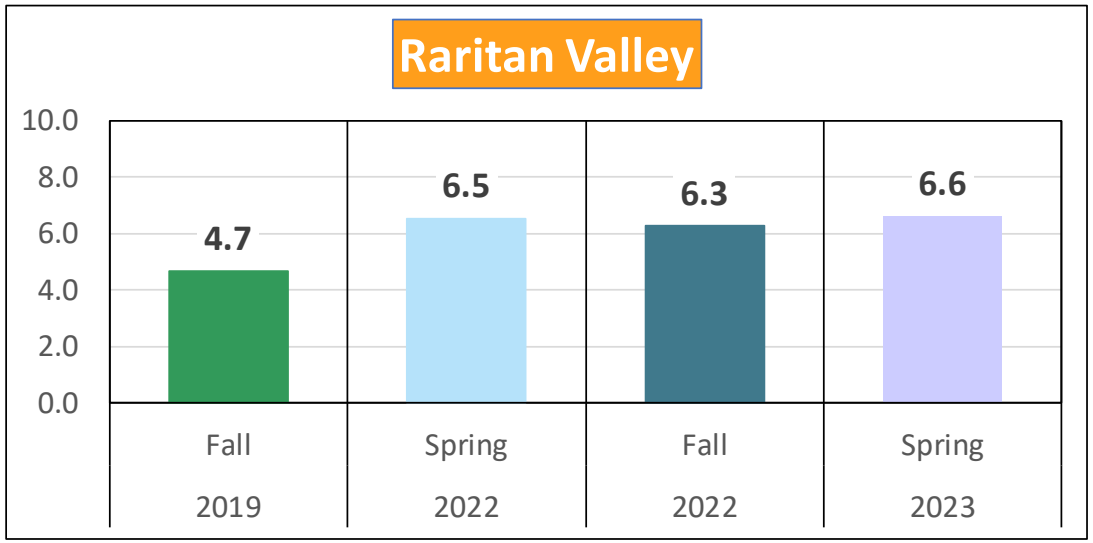


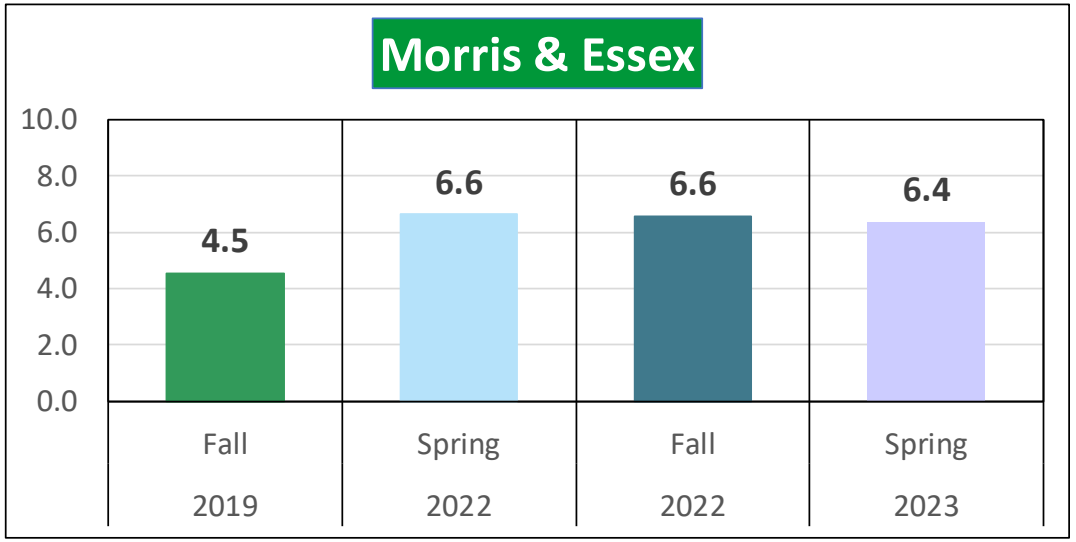
TRANSIT

Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT by Rail Market





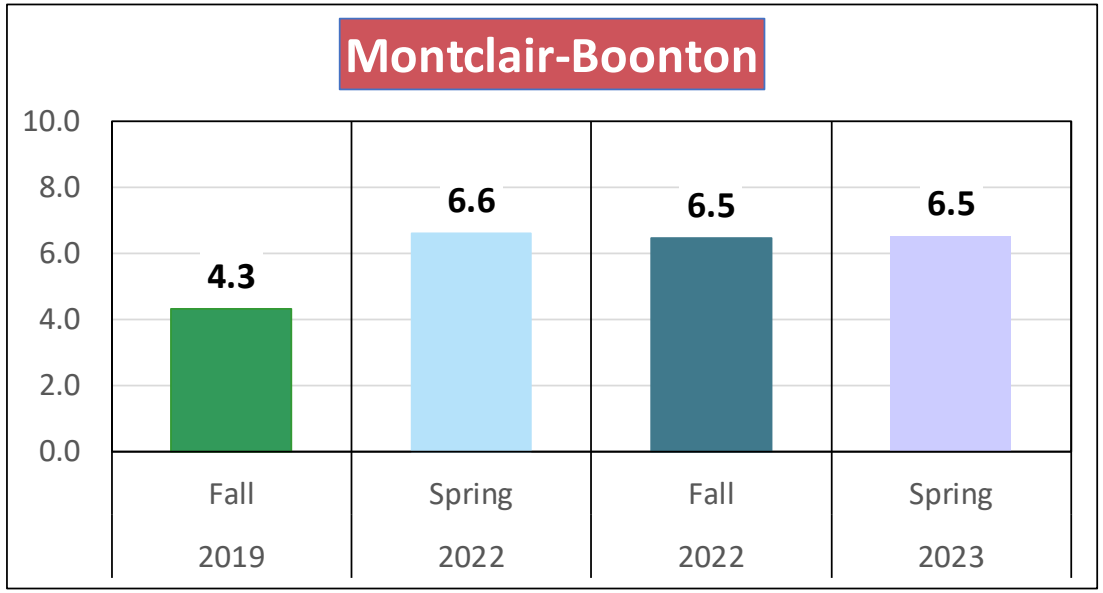


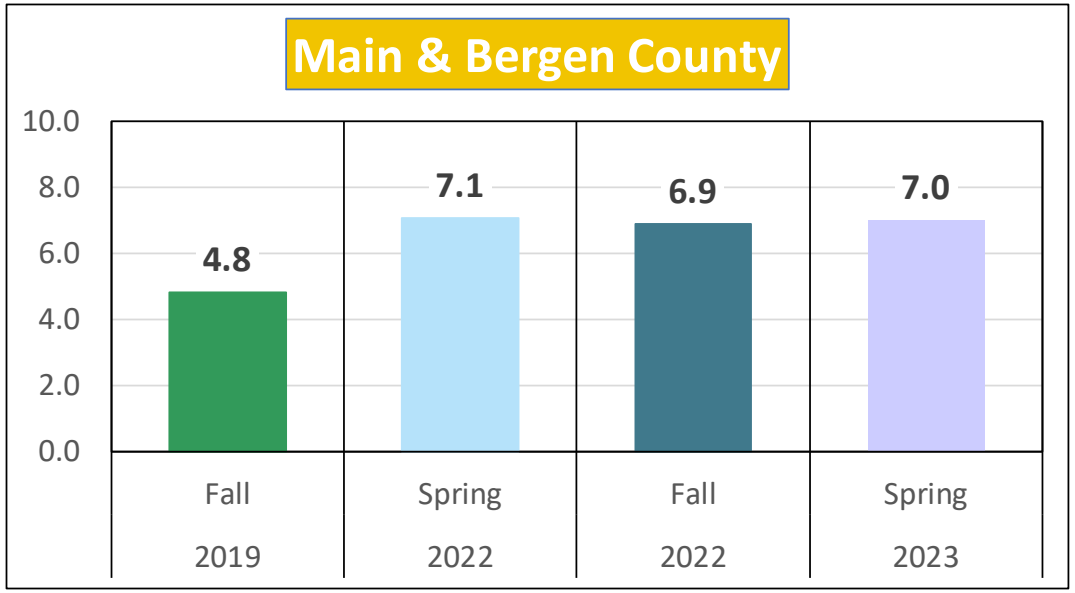


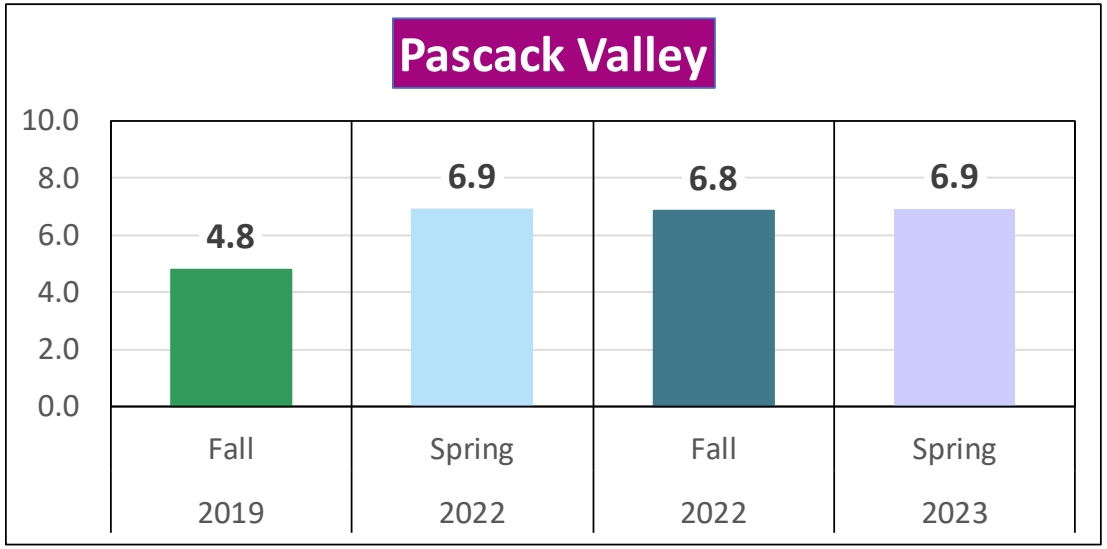
TRANSIT

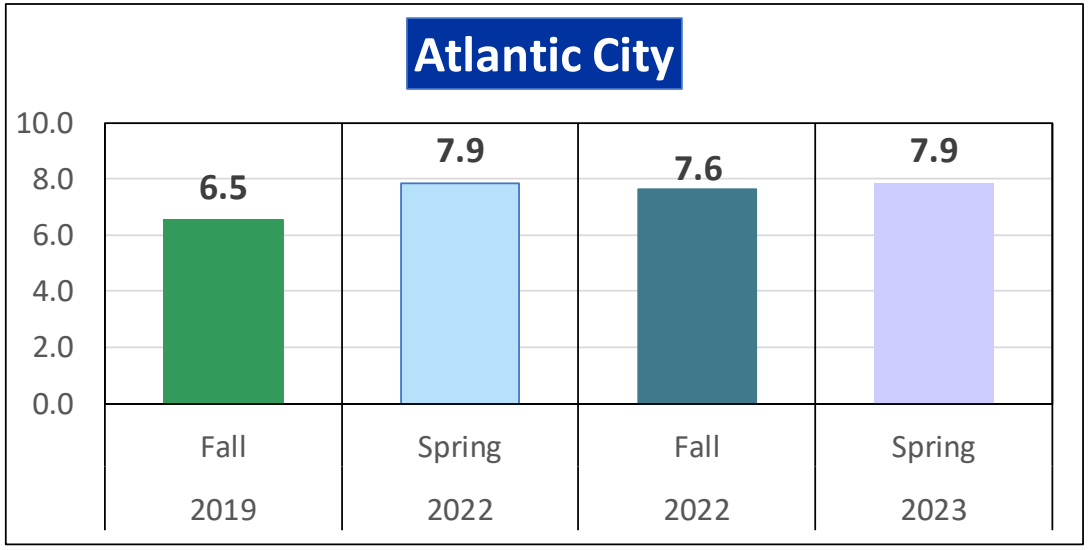
Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT by Rail Market

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023



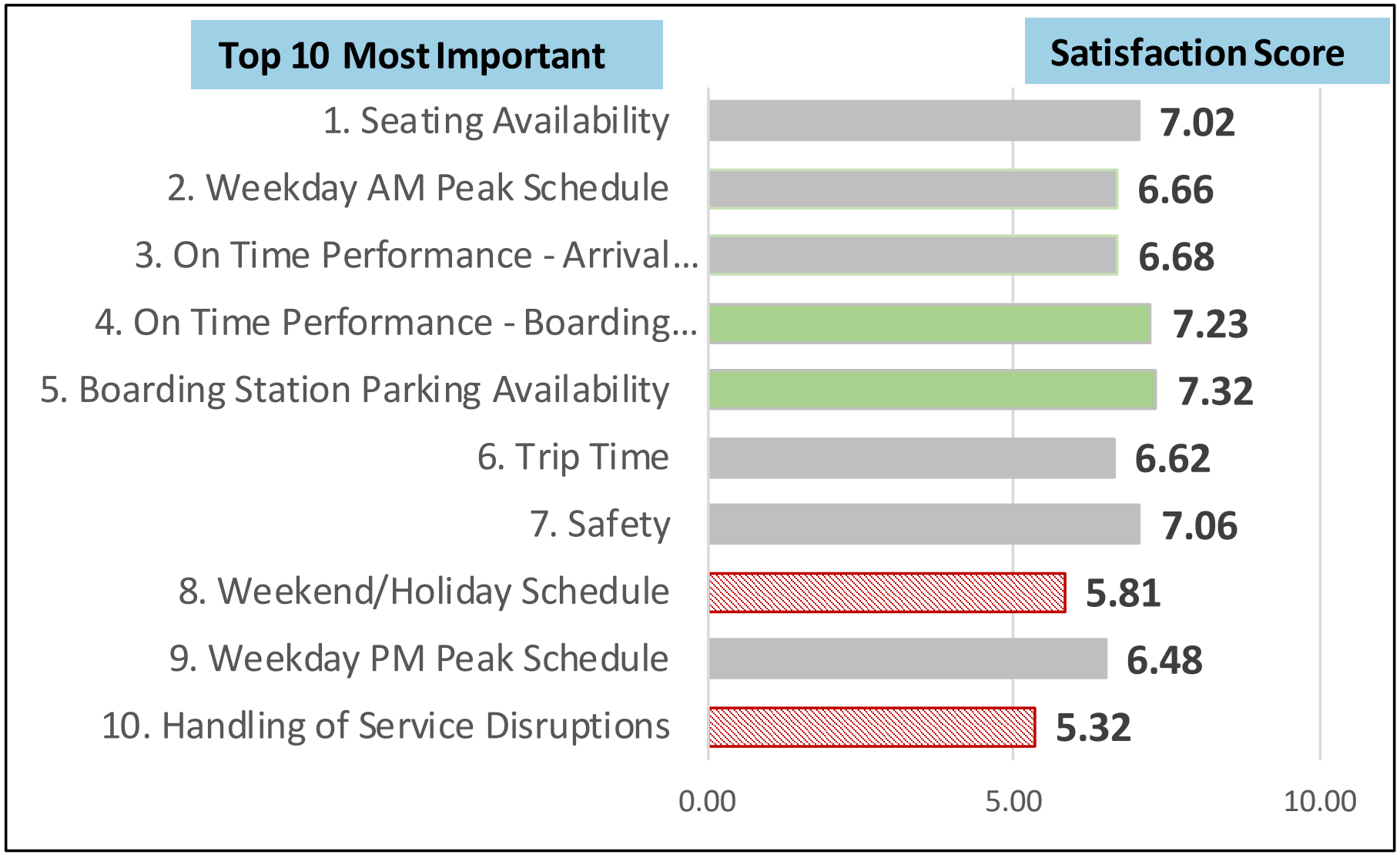






NJ TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL CUSTOMERS



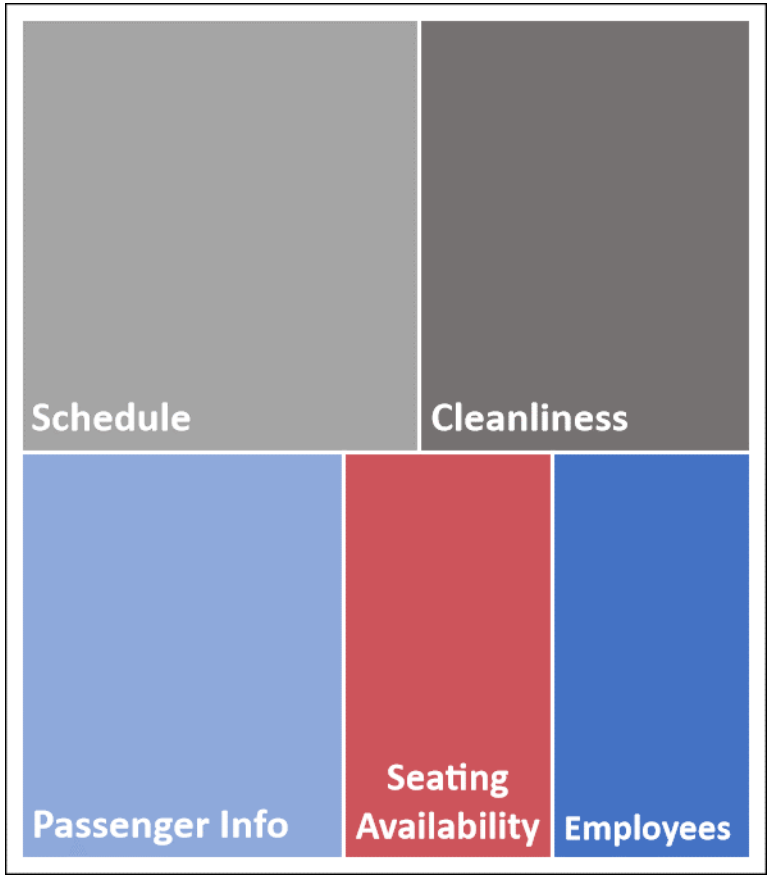
	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of RAIL Comments

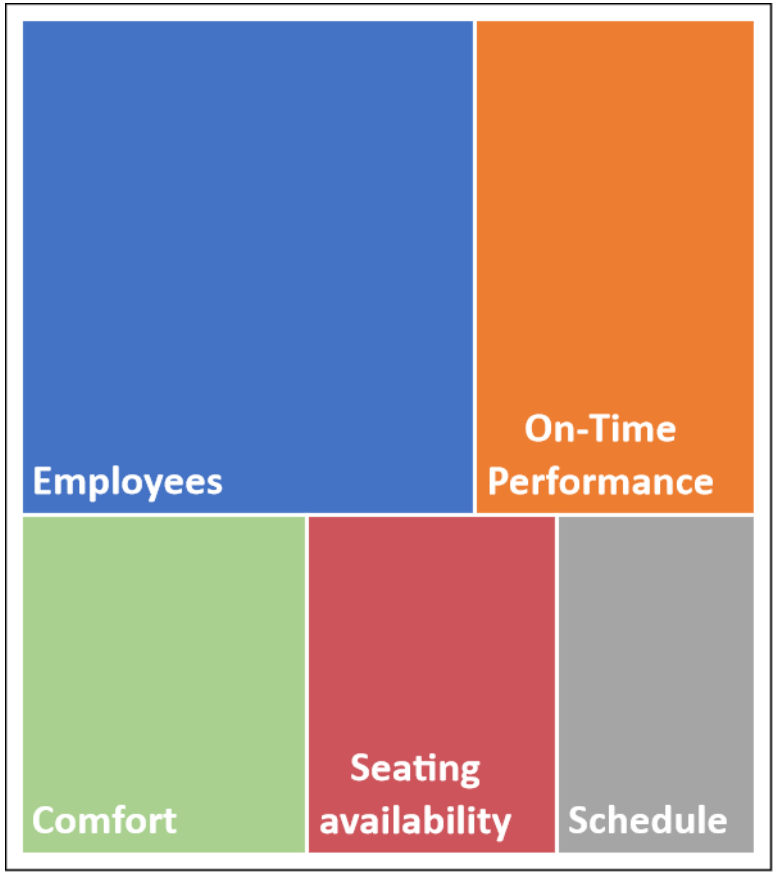
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



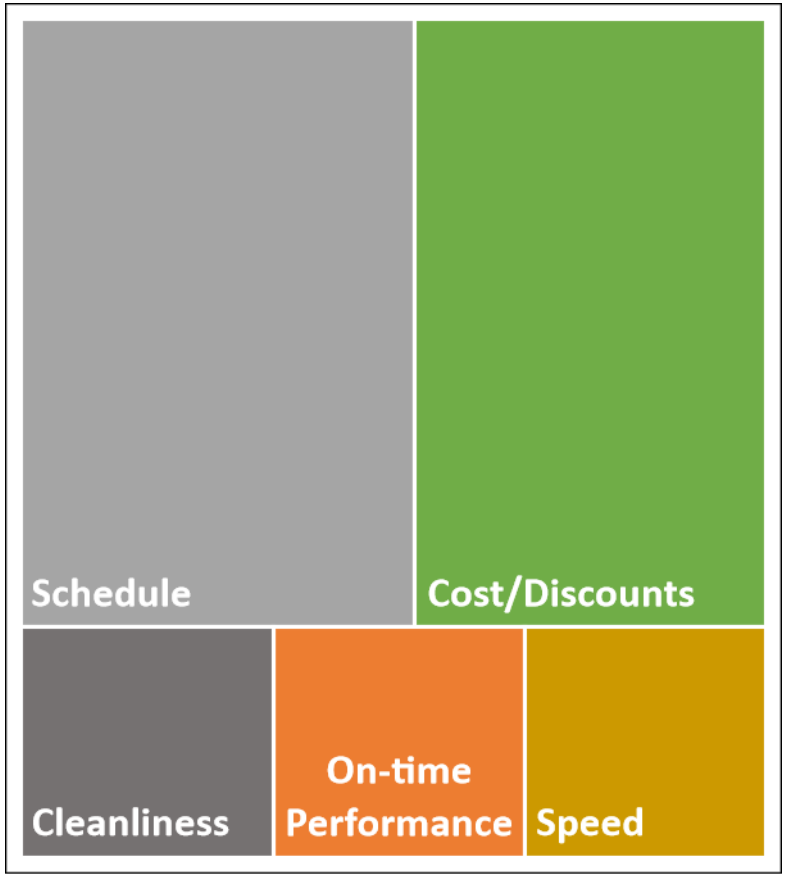
9,835 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



9,341 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



8,916 "Encourage" Comments

14,507 Rail Surveys

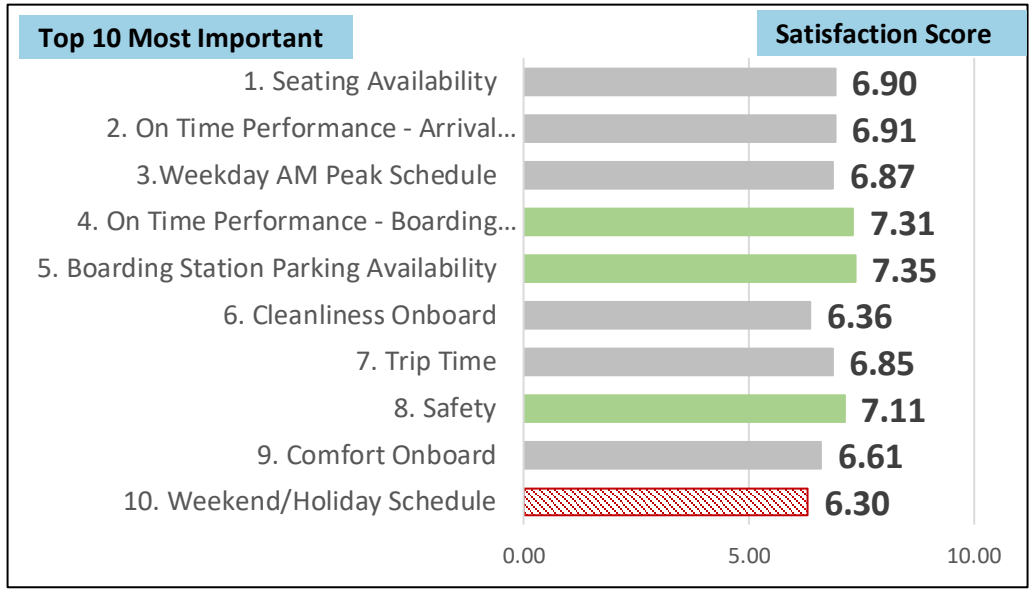
TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

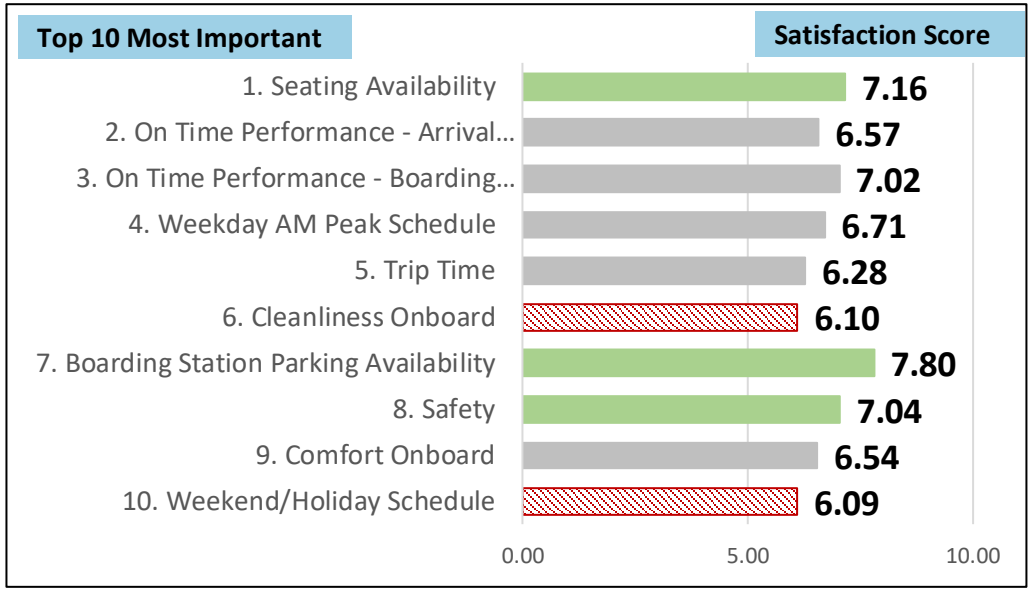
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2023

Northeast Corridor

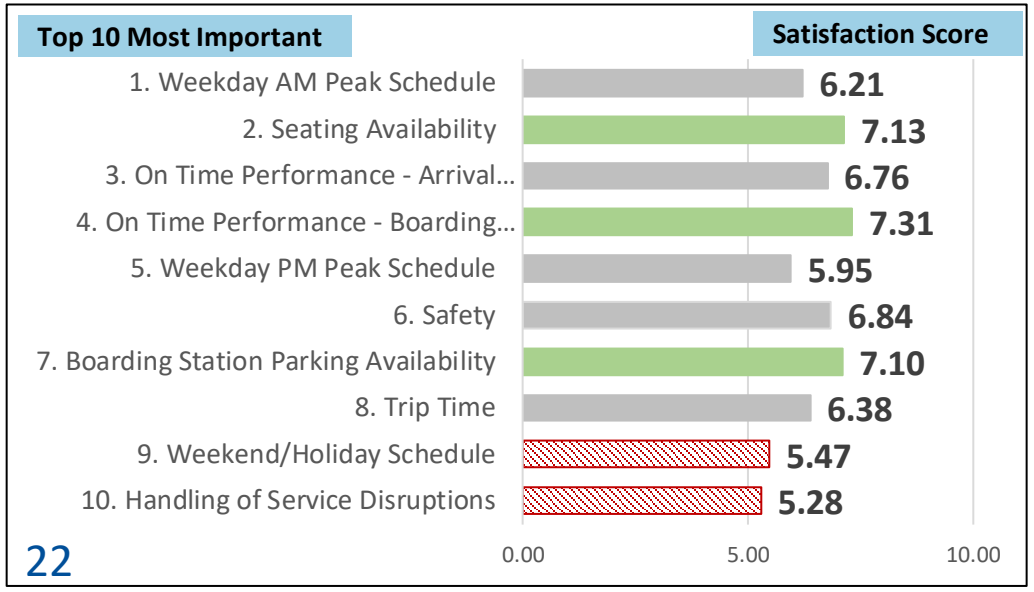


North Jersey Coast

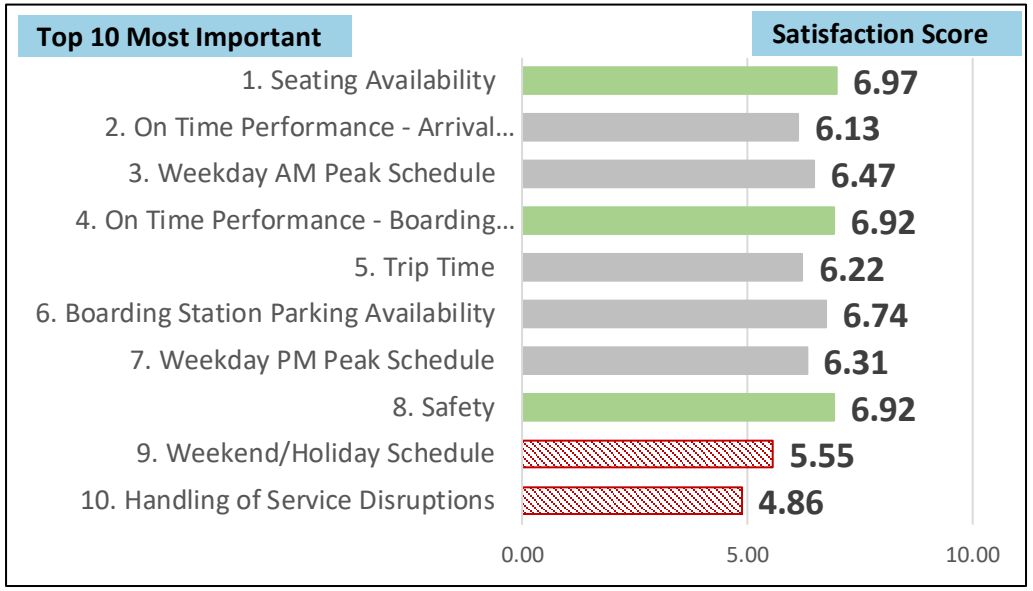


	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

Raritan Valley



Morris & Essex



TRANSIT

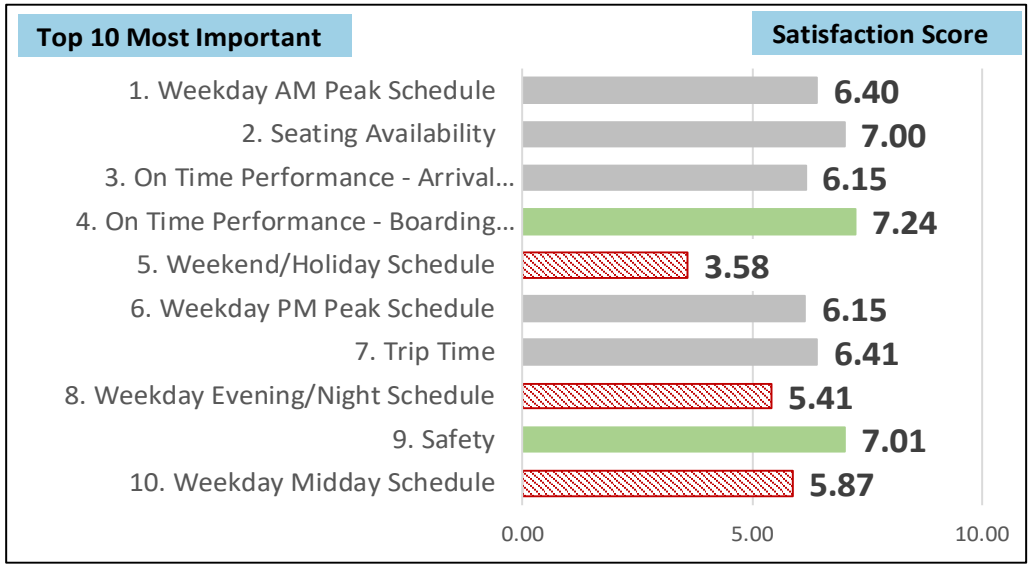
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

Customer Satisfaction Survey

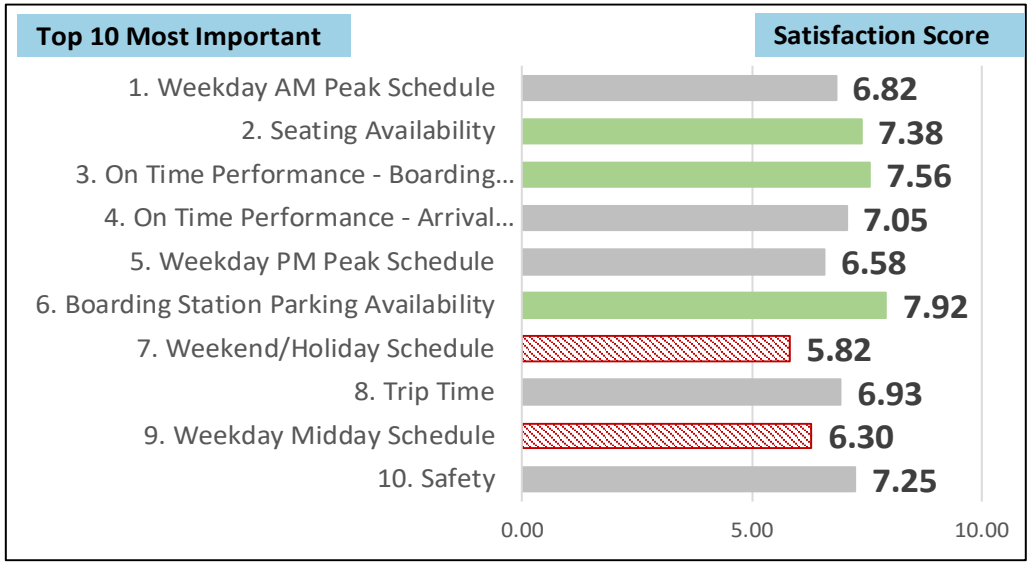
Spring 2023

	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

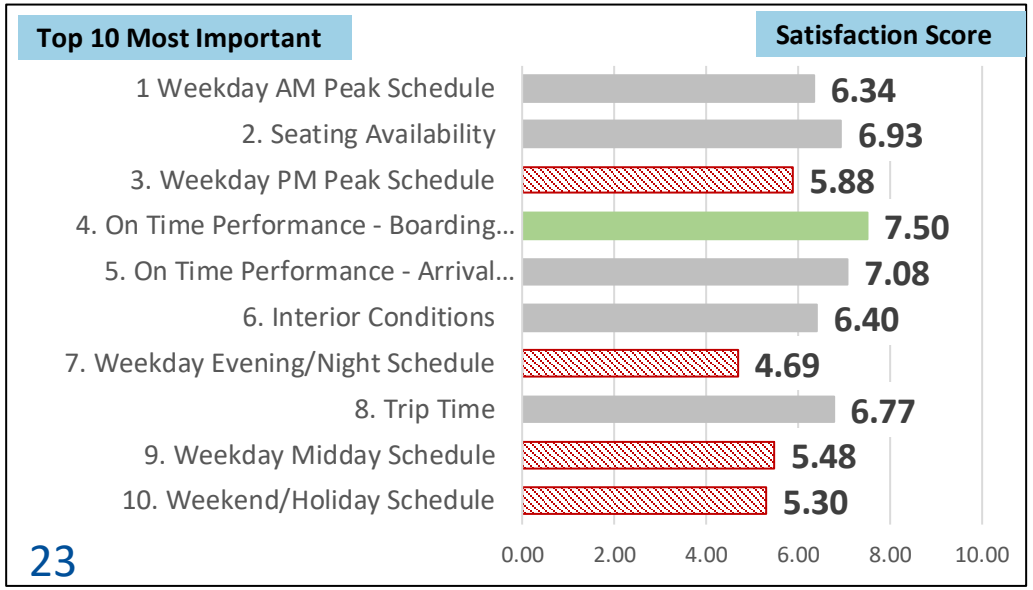
Montclair-Boonton



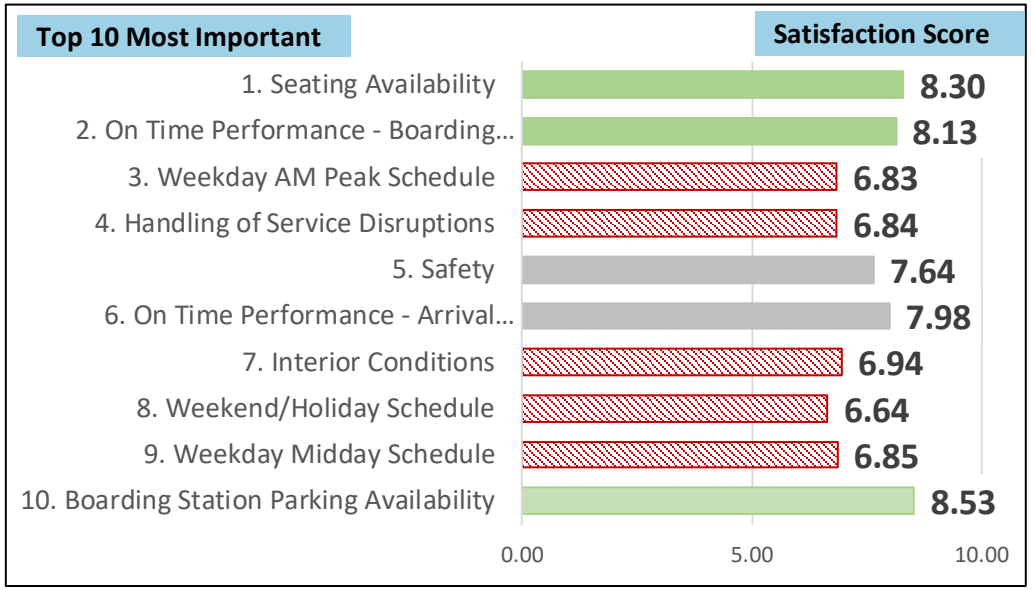
Main-Bergen/Port Jervis



Pascack Valley



ATLANTIC CITY RAIL LINE



NJ TRANSIT

Rail Score Context

Rail Operations constantly strives to make improvements to enhance the customer experience. Some of the improvements we have made last year are listed below:

- *Service Planning*
  - Added additional weekend service at Garwood Station along with full weekday off peak service.
  - Retimed off peak one seat Raritan Valley line service to work better with track outages.
  - Worked to ensure consistency of same platform transfer with Raritan Valley trains in Newark Penn Station.
  - Refined the weekday midday schedule on the Pascack Valley Line to improve trip time and on time performance.
- *Mechanical*
  - Continue to roll out the new ALP45A locomotives to improve fleet reliability
  - As we have seen a drop in rating for interior cleanliness, we have implemented a new process to improve the interior cleanliness of fleet.

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

- *Infrastructure*
  - **Edison**: New waiting room doors
  - **Rahway:** New LED lighting in tunnel
  - **Clifton:** New LED lighting entire station and parking lot
  - **Newark Broad Street**:
    - New diamond plate metal exterior staircase
    - #1 and #2 elevators modernized
  - **Morristown**: All new platform benches
  - **Hamilton:** Westbound elevator modernization
  - **Glen Rock**: New LED lighting
  - **Montvale:** New LED lighting
  - **Ridgewood:** New LED lighting
  - **South Amboy:** #2, #3 elevator modernization
  - **Newark Penn Station**:
    - Escalator #10 and #17 modernization
    - Historic globe light restoration
    - Waiting room bench renovation
    - Main waiting room Terrazzo floor repairs
    - Air curtains

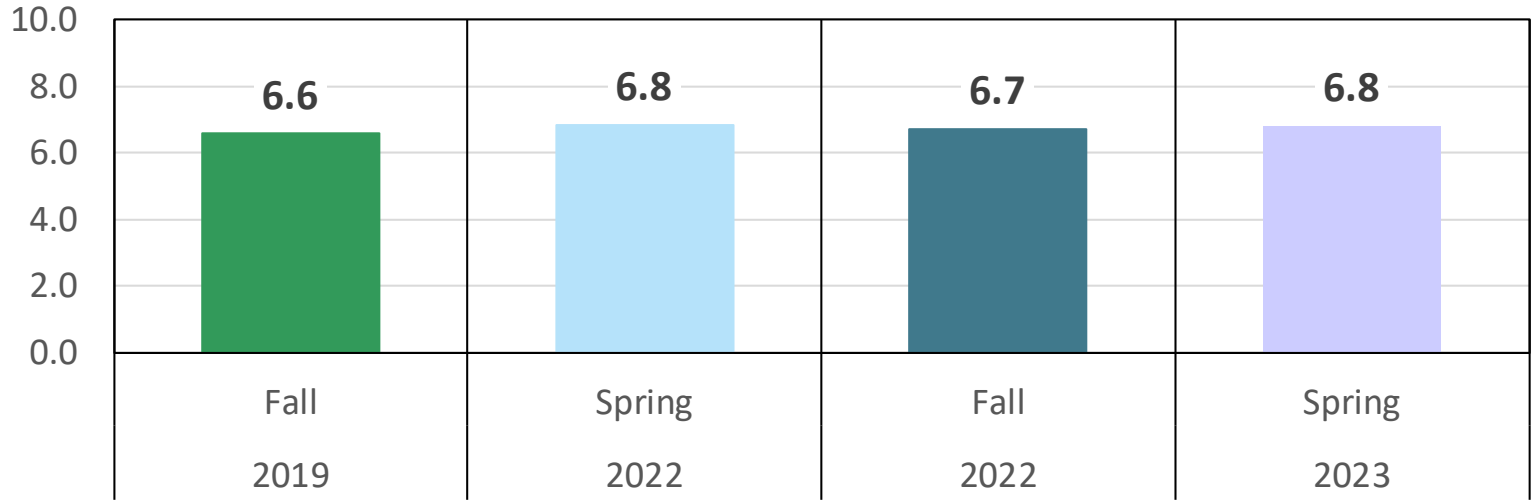
TRANSIT

LIGHT RAIL

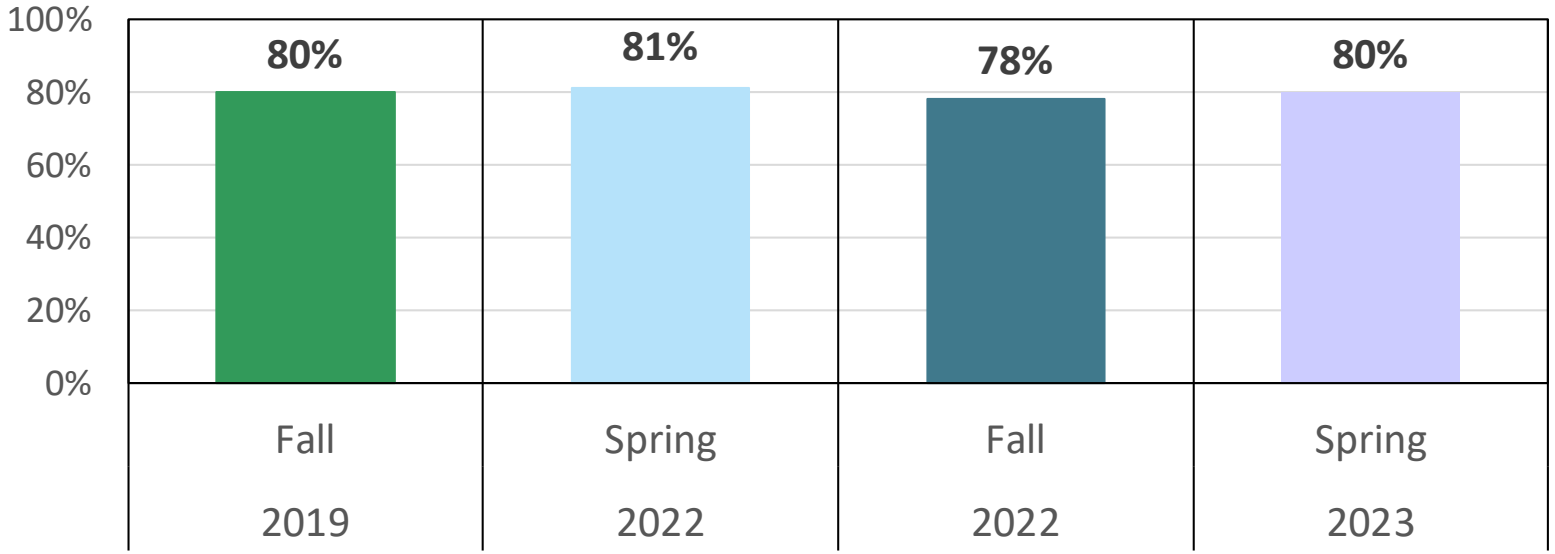
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2023

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



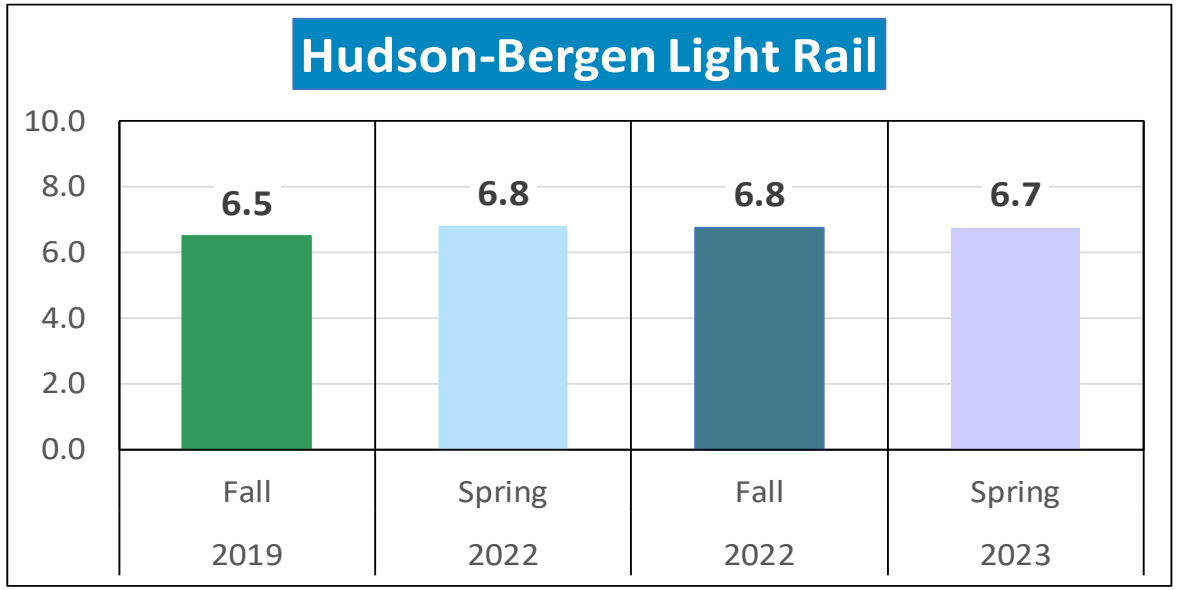
LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT

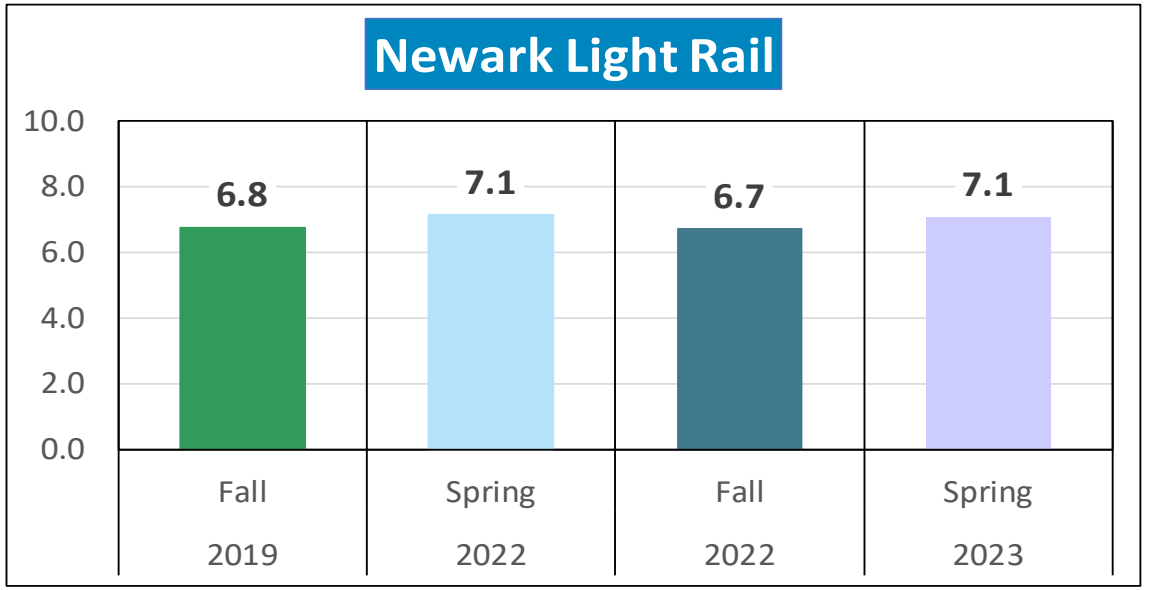


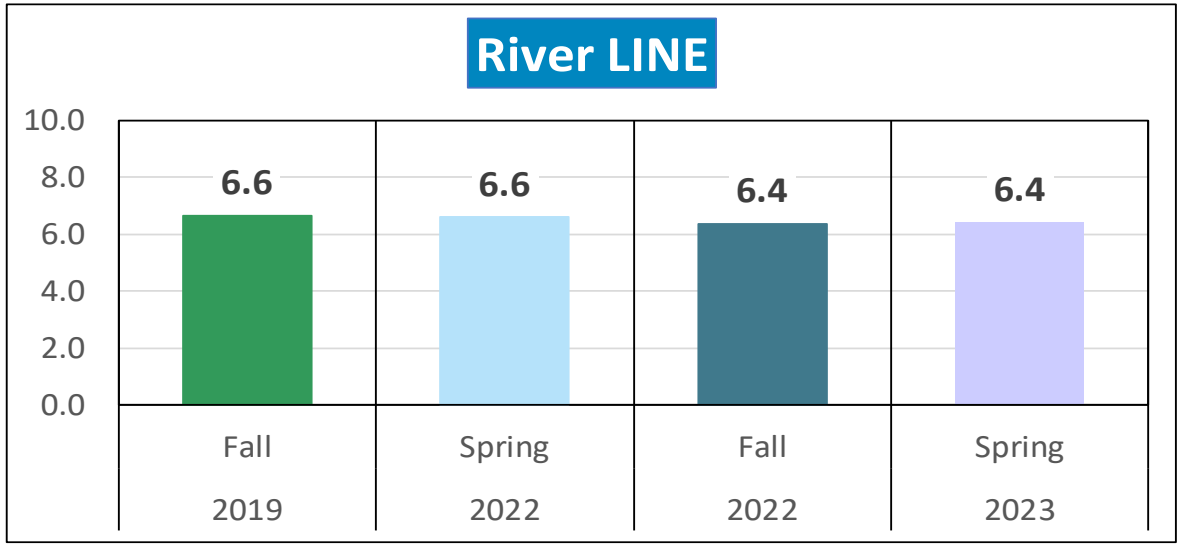
NJ TRANSIT

Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT by Light Rail Market

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023







- Hudson-Bergen Overall Satisfaction is 6.7 for the Spring 2023 survey
- Newark Light Rail increased from 6.7 to 7.1
- River LINE remained the same at 6.4

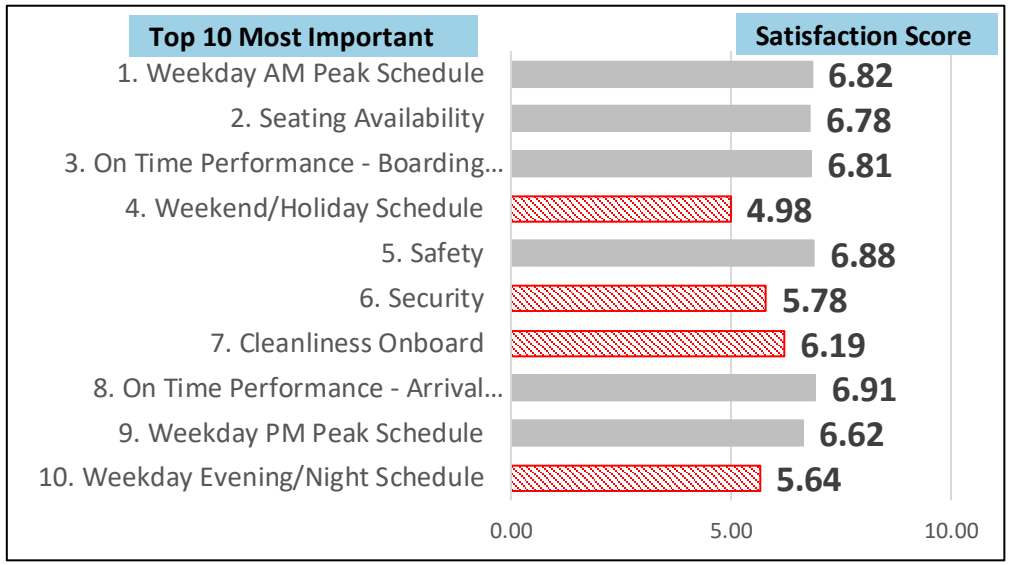
TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for LIGHT RAIL Customers by Light Rail Line and Score

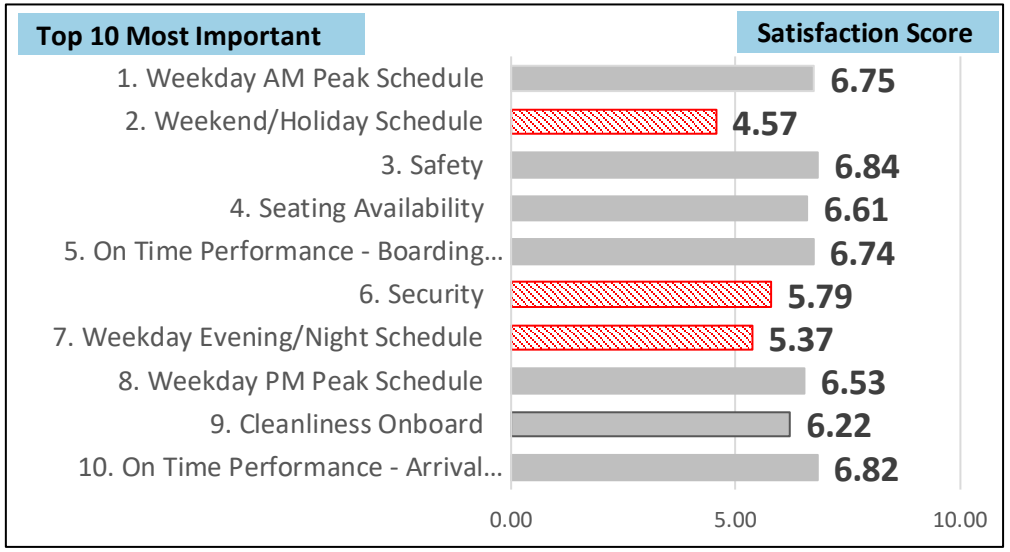
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2023

LIGHT RAIL SYSTEM

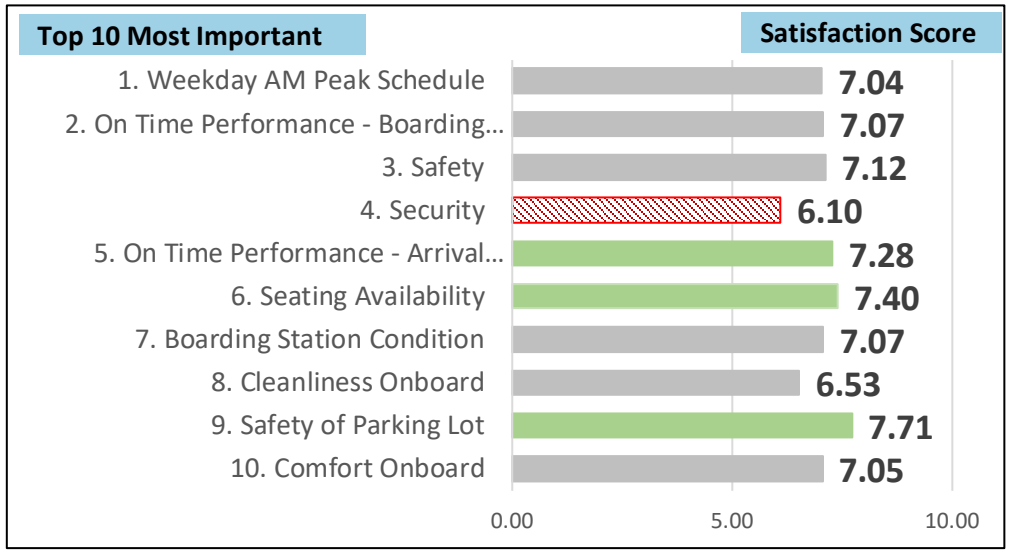


Hudson Bergen Light Rail

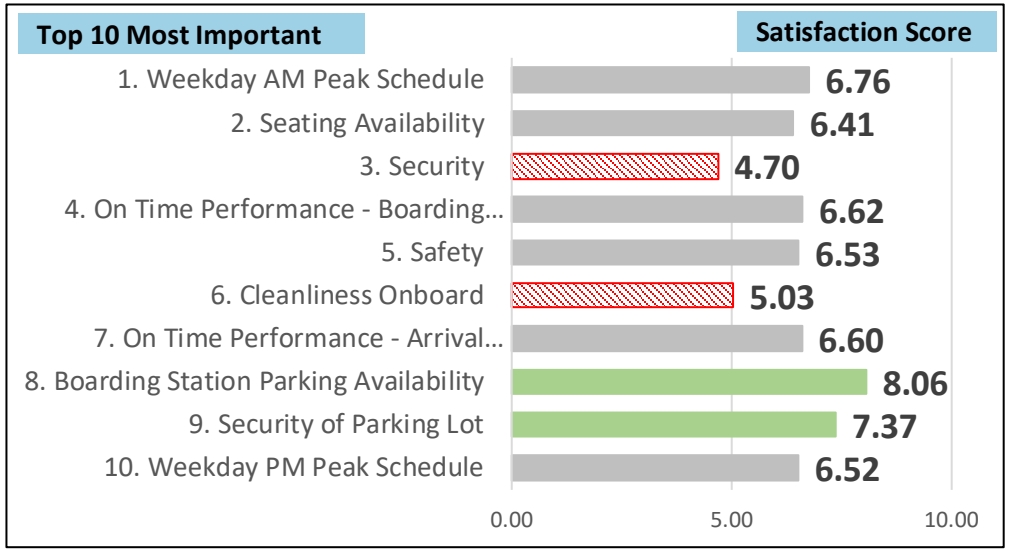


	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

Newark Light Rail



River LINE

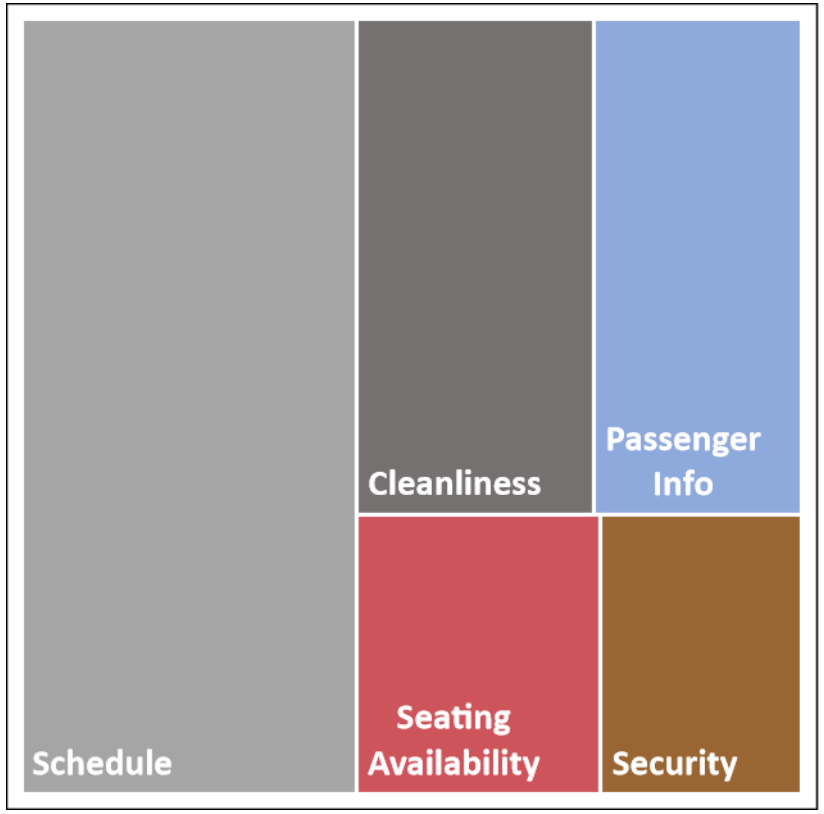


NJ TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of LIGHT RAIL Comments

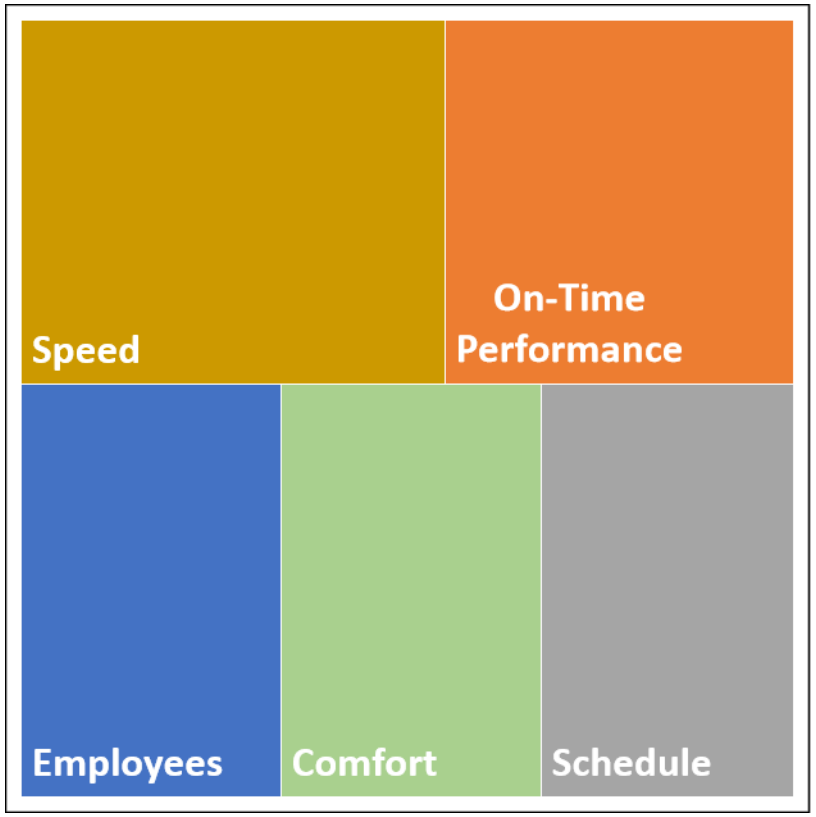
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



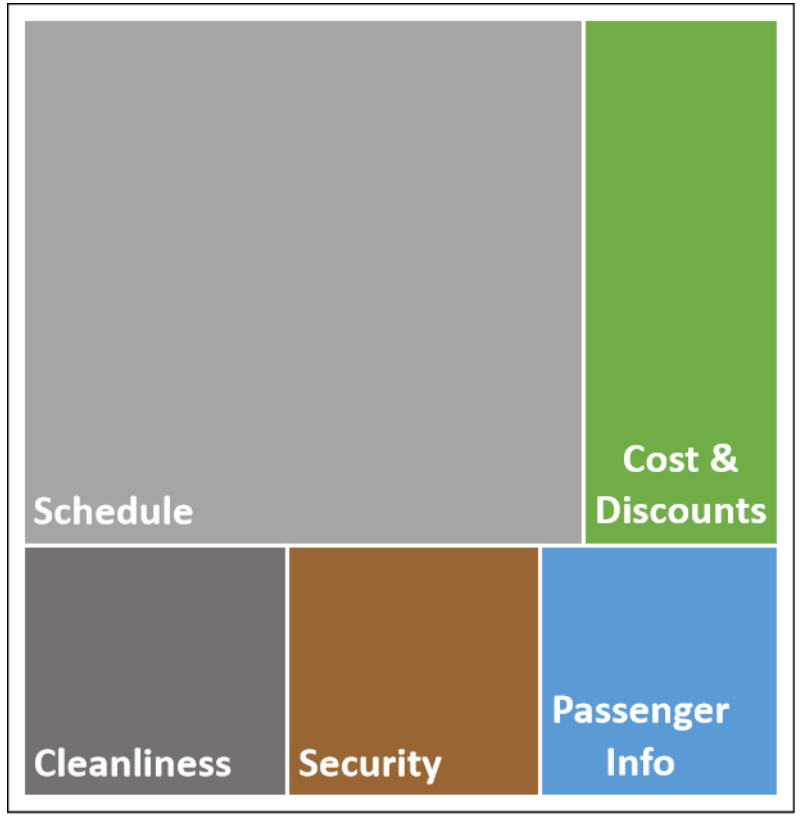
681 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



641 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



628 "Encourage" Comments

1,108 Light Rail Surveys

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

Hudson-Bergen Light Rail

- Improved communications score due to signage, timely advisories regarding weekend track work, and consistent announcements onboard trains and at stations
- Continued work on improving security score through coordination with NJTP and local police jurisdictions
- Decrease in overall facility score attributed to issues with parking at certain stations, including payment and availability

TRANSIT

Light Rail Score Context

Newark Light Rail

- Improved scores related to on-time performance, light rail vehicle (LRV) condition, facility condition, scheduling, and passenger communications
- Continued maintenance of the entire system and LRVs, as well as the mitigation of the impact of any incidents, have helped maintain and improve OTP
- Improved communications score attributed to station signage, announcements, and service advisories
- Improved facility condition score related to regular maintenance of stations, recent station improvements across NLR, and spring/summer landscaping
- While necessary maintenance and construction projects take place primarily during the weekends, Newark Light Rail has taken steps to ensure service can run as efficiently as possible with adjustments and supplemental service where necessary and possible

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

River Line

- Improved scores related to overall operational capacity and communications, with a decreased score related to parking facilities
- Improved communications, including the deployment of station ambassadors to communicate changes in service and issuing service advisories
- In the event of service disruptions, River Line provides supplemental service to mitigate impacts to customers
- Similar to the HBLR, River Line's decrease in facility parking satisfaction can generally be correlated to TVM issues and parking capacity limitations
- Current challenges related to vehicle maintenance and operator availability that have been impacting reliability this summer may impact scores for the next survey period

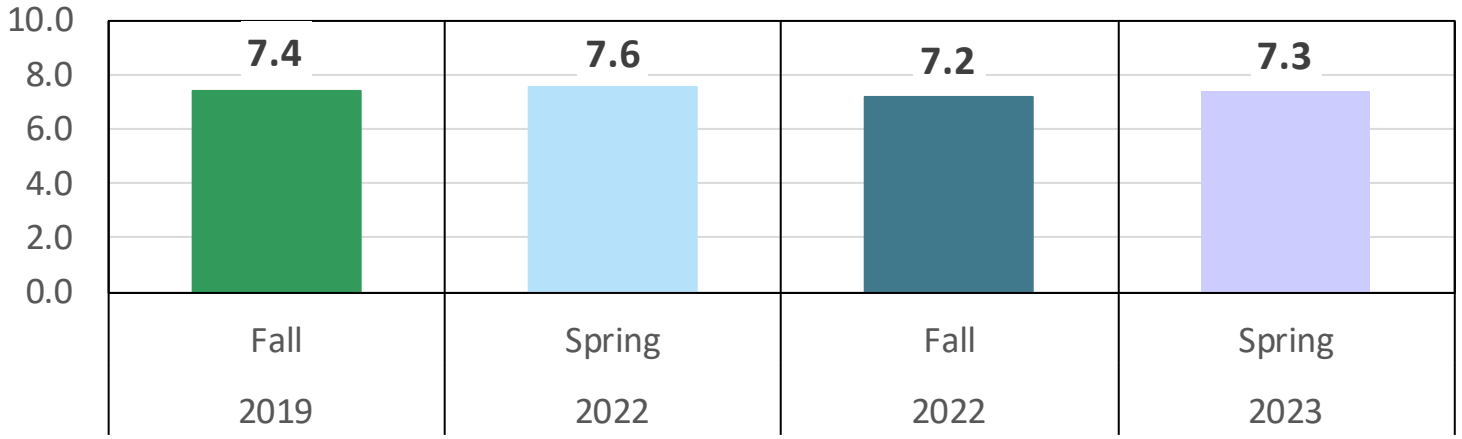
TRANSIT

Access Link

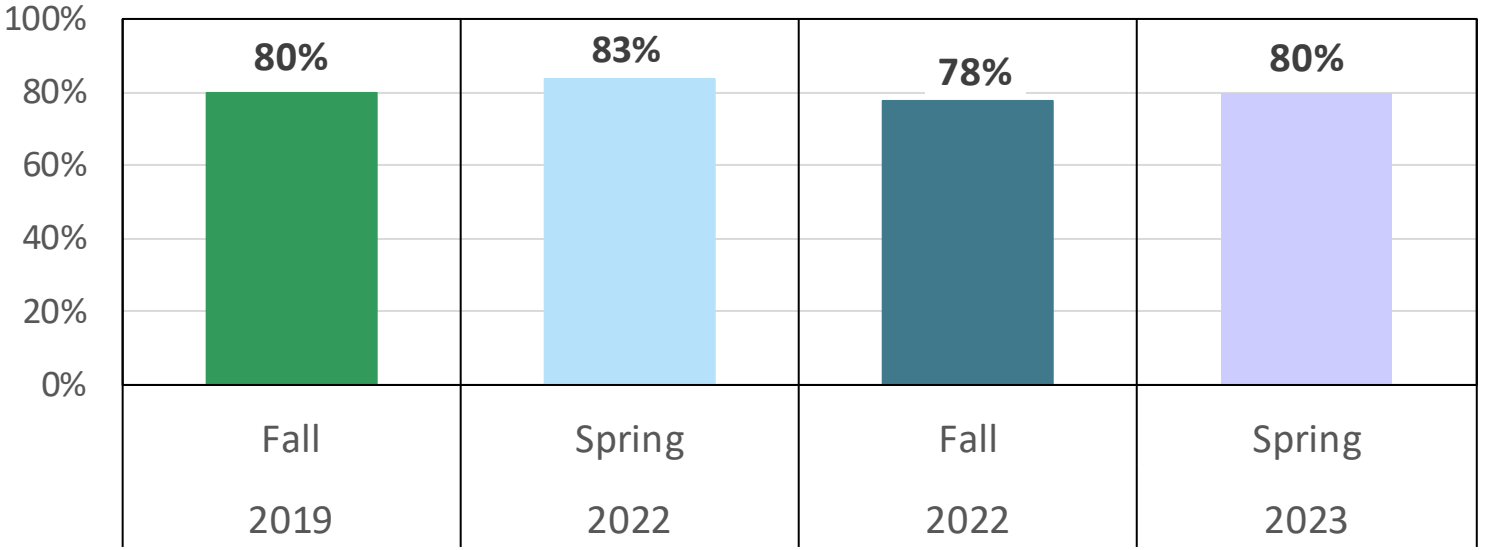
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2023

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



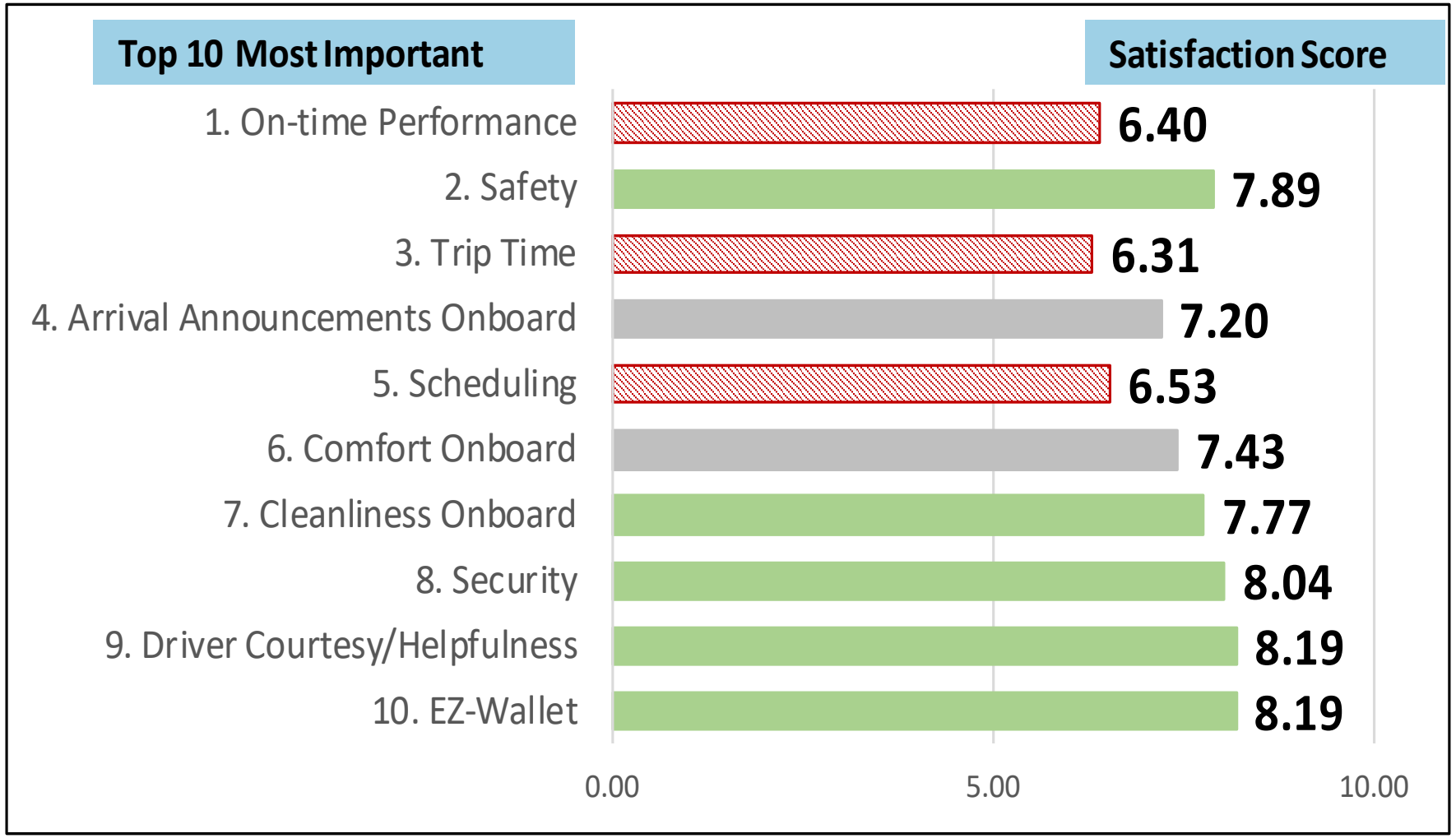
LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT



- ACCESS LINK Overall Satisfaction score increased to 7.3 for the Spring 2023 survey from 7.2 in the Fall 2022
- Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT to a friend or family member also increased to 80% from 78% in the Fall 2022

NJ TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for ACCESS LINK Customers



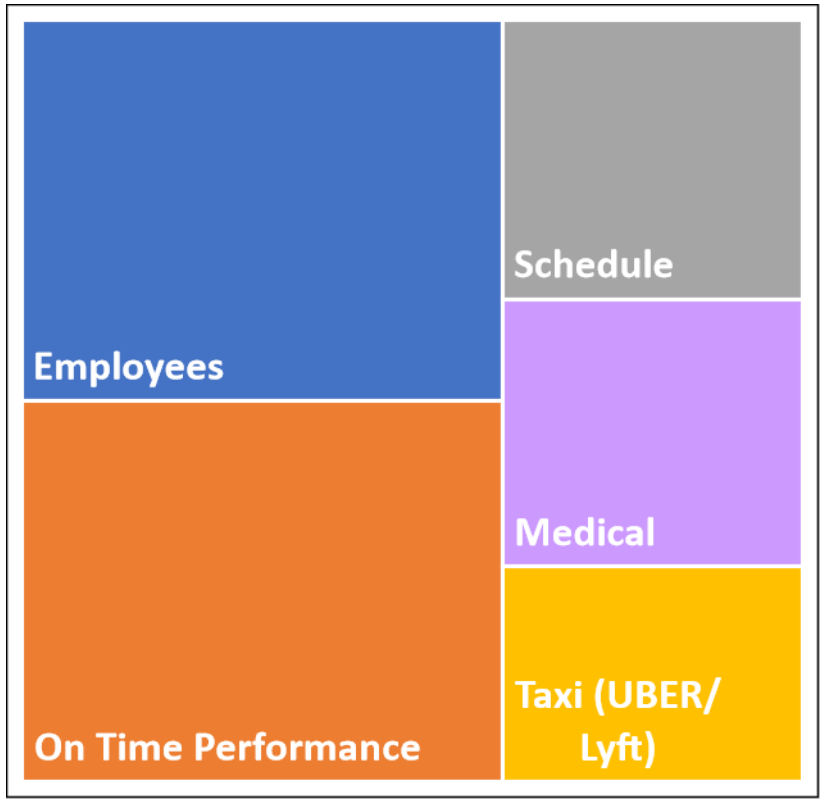
	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of Access Link Comments

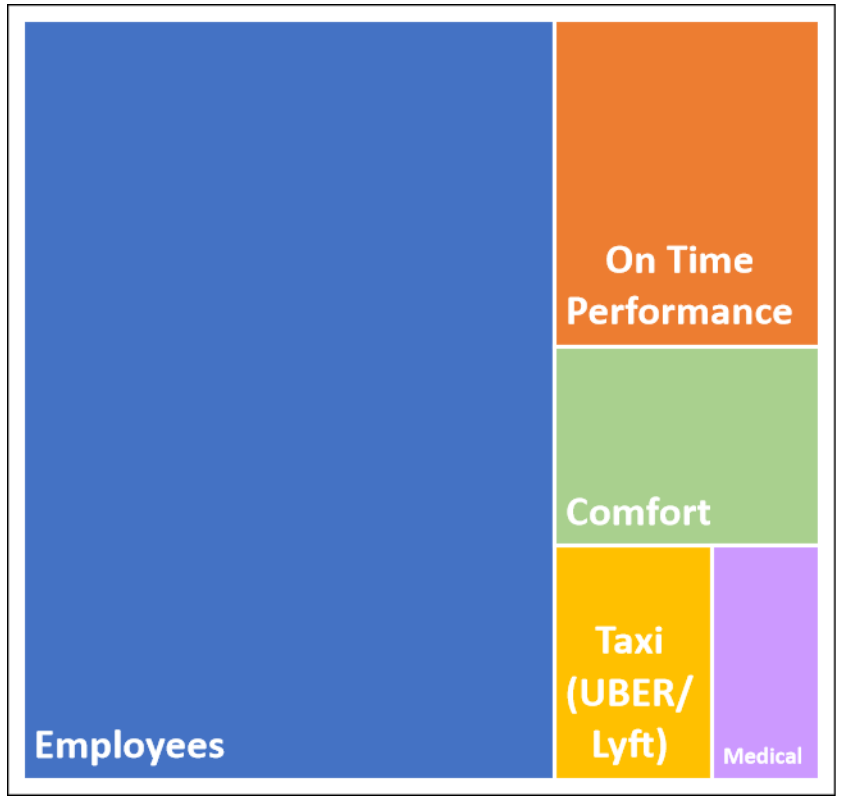
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2023

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



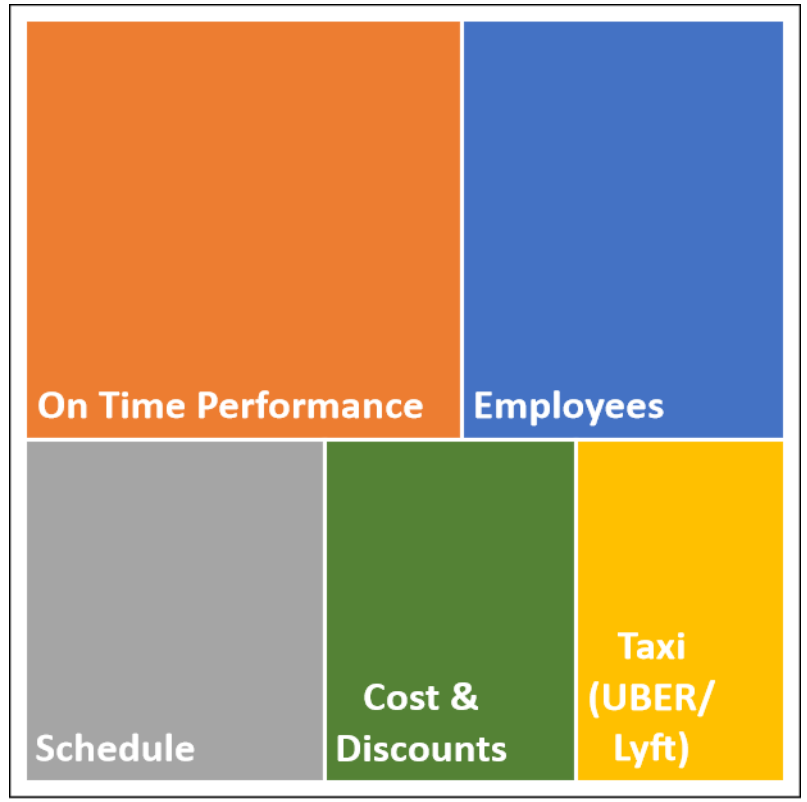
896 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



861 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



823 "Encourage" Comments

1,543 Access Link Surveys

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

TNC Pilot

- Launched the Riders' Choice Pilot Program in May in regions 2 and 5 (Burlington, Camden, Essex, Gloucester, Morris, Somerset, Union, and Salem)
- Customers can opt in to receive rides from Uber and Lyft
- Expands travel options while enhancing timeliness and efficiency
- More than 3,000 Access Link customers opted in
- More than 19,000 rides provided by the time the survey period ended
- Monitoring positive impact on OTP and looking at future expansion of the pilot

IVR AI (Replicant Software)

- Launched an enhanced interactive voice response (IVR) telephone system that uses conversational artificial intelligence (AI)
- Provide customers with instant, automated service for Ride Status Checks and Ride Cancellations
- Benefits include instant service with no hold times and 24/7 availability
- Increases the availability of live agents to focus on more complex requests
- Absorbed approximately 20 percent of calls from Access Link Service Monitor staff since launching

TRANSIT

Access Link Score Context

Employee Training

- Hired additional staff to improve the overall training curriculum for Access Link, which will help to improve overall employee performance

On-Time Performance

- Implemented the Service Infraction (No-Show) policy effective July 1, which will impact future survey scores
- Will help to improve on-time performance and ride times
- Holds customers accountable for trips that arrive at the customer's pick-up location on time, and the customer is not there to board and did not call-in advance to cancel their reservation
- Each no-show results in at least a 10-minute delay to a trip while we follow confirmation procedures
- Will help reduce unnecessary travel time experienced by other customers on these trips
- Will use a progressive scale of warnings and actions for consistent no-shows so that we can better serve customers who are consistently showing up for their pick-ups

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Summary

- 2023 Spring Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT Score is 6.9
- 82 percent of customers would recommend NJ TRANSIT – the largest percent to recommend since the survey started
- The scores and customer comments have been shared with the operating groups
- Scores will be posted on the NJ TRANSIT website
- The next survey will be administered in the Fall of 2023

TRANSIT